



Gamma RP

1st Edition

A simple roleplaying system meant to be dynamic and expansible

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Introduction

Gamma RP, or ΓRP, is a tabletop role-playing game (TTRPG) system meant to strike a balance between pure theater-of-the-mind systems and map based tabletop systems.

I've found that the most engaging TTRPG systems for me were ones that had a visual element, but these by necessity often put a lot of burden of preparation on the moderator(s) of the game. They also can indirectly limit the amount of improvisation possible by the players since the moderator needs to prepare visual assets based on what the players choose, and this slows down the game.

It also takes time away from world-building.

For me, the motivation for being the moderator (or game master, dungeon master, etc.) of a TTRPG is to build a world that my players can explore, interact with, and build characters and parts of the world themselves. I needed a system where any maps, items, or enemies could be very quickly created from scratch on-the-fly by an untrained game master.

So, faced with my perpetual scarcity of free time, I naturally decided to spend a few years creating ΓRP and the Gamma Nebula Setting before actually sitting down and playing with my friends.

The ΓRP system and the Gamma Nebula Setting are separated into different sections of this rulebook. The base system of rules is meant to be easy to build on top of, but the Gamma Nebula Setting is the setting that I initially built it for. Given how much work I've put into both, I am of the mind to release them together for anyone else that may want to use the pre-built setting.

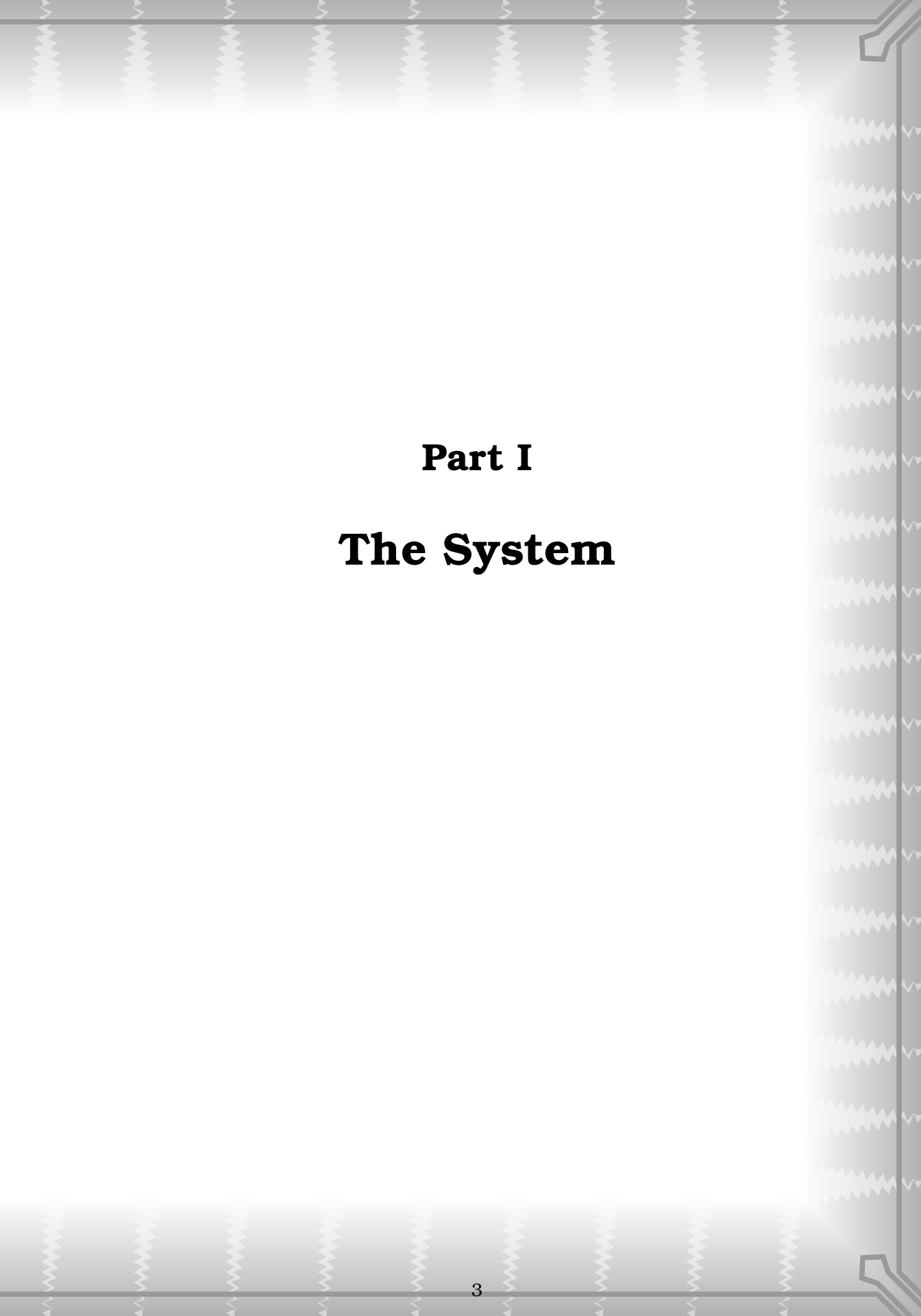
I heavily encourage any users of this system to build their own settings on top of this system.

I need to make this introduction more sensible and legible, but for now this placeholder will suffice!

Enjoy!

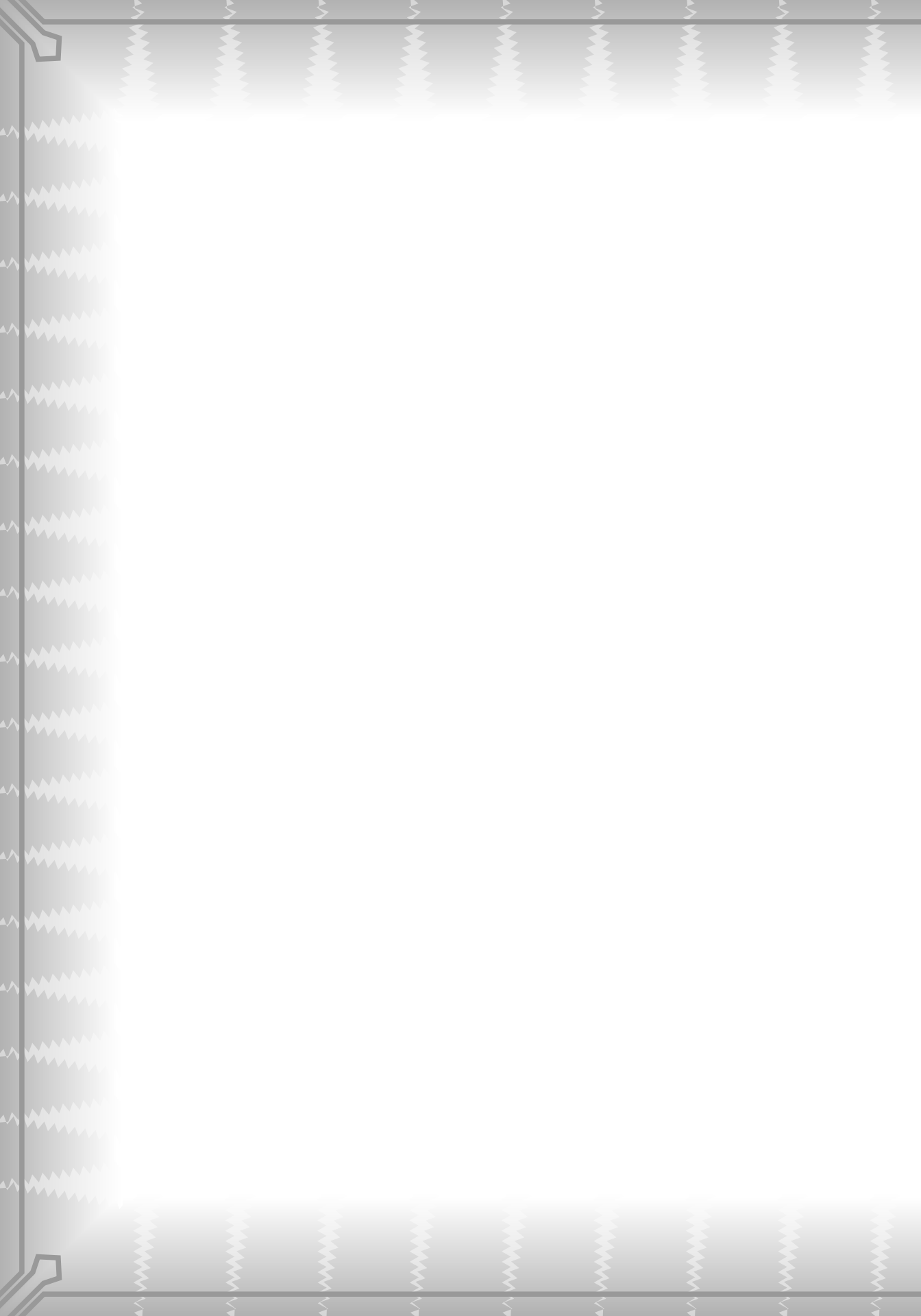
Here is a purely tikz generated logo attempt:

Gamma RP, or  ΓRP is so cool that I use it to preserve food in my refrigerator



Part I

The System



2 The Basics

TRP is a tabletop role-playing game. This is a specific class of improvisational acting game in which the participants are divided into *Game Masters* (often referred to as GM's) and *Players*. Most games will require at least one game master in order to play the game, and the game master and players work together to tell a story.

The Game Master is responsible for constructing the world around the Players, and giving the players a setting to interact with. The Players are responsible for maintaining a Player Character—a character who interacts with and influences the setting defined by the Game Master.

Since the game is collaborative in this way, it is more fun and fair if there is an element of chance in deciding how a scene unfolds. TRP uses the roll of a set of dice to decide whether an unsure course of action is successful.



The fundamental dice mechanic in TRP is based on 12 sided dice, and rolls several at a time. If you intend to play the game on a real physical tabletop (rather than one of the increasingly popular virtual ones), you may want to obtain at least a dozen 12 sided dice for convenience. It is possible to play with fewer dice by rolling one die at a time.

2.1 Dice Rolling Basics

The notation for a roll in TRP is written as $RXaY$, which verbally is pronounced as “Roll X a Y ”

- X is the number of dice you roll.

- Y is the *advantage* on the roll, which indicates that the top Y numbers of a die pass the success threshold.

If any of the dice you roll pass the success threshold, then your roll is a success.

The quickest way to judge if your advantaged roll is a success is:

1. Add the advantage to the value of each die in your roll
2. If $[\text{ADVANTAGE}] + [\text{DIE VALUE}] > 12$ for any die in your roll, your roll is a success.

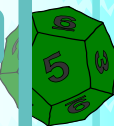
An advantage of 0 is the exception to this: $RXa0$ is still successful if any of the dice roll a 12. Both larger X and larger Y indicate a higher probability of success.



Let's look at a few example rolls.

Table 2a: Advantage Examples

ROLL	DICE	RESULT
R5a1	① ① ① ⑧ ④ ⑩	FAILURE
R5a1	① ① ② ⑫ ②	SUCCESS
R4a1	① ① ⑧ ⑩	FAILURE
R4a2	① ⑪ ⑧ ⑩	SUCCESS
R4a3	① ⑪ ⑧ ⑩	SUCCESS
R3a3	① ⑨ ⑧	FAILURE
R3a4	① ⑨ ⑧	SUCCESS
R3a8	② ④ ③	FAILURE
R3a9	② ④ ③	SUCCESS



Advantage can also be negative. For convenience this is written as *disadvan-*

tage which is the negative of the advantage. A roll of $RXa(-Z)$ is written equivalently as $RXdZ$.

For a roll at *disadvantage* of Z to be successful, in addition to having at least one die in the roll land on 12, there must also be at least Z dice within the roll displaying a number above 1.

The quickest way to judge if your disadvantaged roll is a success is:

- 1. Check if there are any dice showing 12 in your roll
- 2. Count the number of dice that show a value above 1
- 3. If $[NUMBER\ OF\ DICE\ ABOVE\ 1] > [DISADVANTAGE]$ for *any* die in your roll, and there is at least one die showing 12, your roll is a success.

Note that the rolls $RXa1$, $RXa0$, and $RXd1$ are all actually identical, with all three requiring a single dice of the set to result 12 in order to result a success.

Lets look at a few example disadvantage rolls.

Table 2b: Disadvantage Examples

ROLL	DICE	RESULT
R2d1	12 ₁ 2 ₂	SUCCESS
R2d1	12 ₁ 1 ₁	SUCCESS
R2d2	12 ₁ 1 ₁	FAILURE
R4d1	11 8 1 10	FAILURE
R4d2	12 ₁ 8 ₂ 1 10 ₃	SUCCESS
R4d3	12 ₁ 8 ₂ 1 10 ₃	SUCCESS
R4d4	12 ₁ 8 ₂ 1 10 ₃	FAILURE
R8d7	12 ₁ 12 ₂ 1 12 ₃ 12 ₄ 12 ₅ 12 ₆ 1	FAILURE

When the disadvantage is greater than or equal to the number of dice being rolled, the roll is an automatic failure even if you have at least one dice showing a 12. If you are asked to make a roll with a disadvantage equal to or greater than the number of dice, you may simply declare a failure. However you may still make the roll if you have abilities that benefit from actually rolling the dice.

Table 2c: Probability of success for various rolls

$RXAY$	$RXd6$	$RXd5$	$RXd4$	$RXd3$	$RXd2$	$RXd1$	$RXa0$	$RXa1$	$RXa2$	$RXa3$	$RXa4$	$RXa5$	$RXa6$	$RXa7$
R1aY	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	8.3%	8.3%	8.3%	16.7%	25.0%	33.3%	41.7%	50.0%	58.3%
R2aY	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	15.3%	16.0%	16.0%	16.0%	30.6%	43.8%	55.6%	66.0%	75.0%	82.6%
R3aY	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20.4%	21.6%	23.0%	23.0%	23.0%	42.1%	57.8%	70.4%	80.2%	87.5%	92.8%
R4aY	0.0%	0.0%	24.0%	25.7%	27.5%	29.4%	29.4%	29.4%	51.8%	68.4%	80.2%	88.4%	93.8%	97.0%
R5aY	0.0%	26.4%	28.4%	30.5%	32.8%	35.3%	35.3%	35.3%	59.8%	76.3%	86.8%	93.2%	96.9%	98.7%
R6aY	27.9%	30.1%	32.5%	35.0%	37.7%	40.7%	40.7%	40.7%	66.5%	82.2%	91.2%	96.1%	98.4%	99.5%

2.2 Modifying Rolls

Very often a character will have a default way they roll something in a situation, but the circumstances of the situation impair or improve their chances of suc-

cess.

When this happens, it is often easier as a GM to specify the roll they must make as a modification of the dice or advantage of their usual roll.

2.2.1 Bonus and Penalty Dice

You should only modify the number of dice for a characters sparingly or if the rulebook specifies that you should do so. Modifying the number of dice is described using the terms “die bonus” and “die penalty”.

If the rules specify you take a W die penalty- then you roll with W fewer dice than you ordinarily would. Die Penalties are abbreviated with $\{-W\}$, for instance- if you see $\{-2\}$ after a roll, it means you take a 2 die penalty to that roll.

If the rules specify you take a X die bonus- then you roll with X more dice than you ordinarily would. Die Bonuses are abbreviated with $\{+X\}$, for instance- if you see $\{+2\}$ after a roll, it means you have a 2 die bonus to that roll.

2.2.2 Additional Advantage and Disadvantage

Modifying the advantage and disadvantage on a roll may be done more freely by the GM than adding dice bonuses or penalties. If the situation is harder than usual, the GM may impose “additional disadvantage” on the players. If the situation has been modified to be easier than usual, the GM may grant “additional advantage” to the players.

If the GM or the rules specify you take Y additional advantage- then you roll with Y higher advantage than you ordinarily would. Additional Advantage is often abbreviated with $\{aaY\}$, for instance- if you see $\{aa2\}$ after a roll, it means you roll with 2 additional advantage.

If the GM or the rules specify you take Z additional disadvantage- then you roll with Z lower advantage than you ordinarily would. Remember that $-Z$ advantage is the same as Z disadvantage. Rolling with additional disadvantage may still leave some net advantage to the roll left over. Additional disadvantage is often abbreviated with $\{ddZ\}$, for instance-

if you see $\{dd2\}$ after a roll, it means you roll with 2 additional disadvantage.

2.3 Group Rolls

Sometimes multiple characters must all individually perform the same task, in a way where their average performance impacts the success of the group. This often happens in situations where one character could catch another character if they fail, by performing well enough. Such a situation calls for a Group Roll.

The process of a Group Roll is as follows:

1. Each character making a Group Roll makes the corresponding roll for the task
2. Count the total number of successes among the group
3. If $[\text{TOTAL SUCCESSES}] \geq [\text{GROUP SIZE}]$ then the group succeeds at the roll.

If you need to count the number of successes for a Group Roll, it is $[\text{TOTAL SUCCESSES}]/[\text{GROUP SIZE}]$ rounded **down** to the nearest whole number.

This may be most easily illustrated with an example.

GM: As you enter the swamp, the mud grows deeper and harder to trudge through. You'll all have to use your Fortitude talent to pass without hurting yourselves.

Alice: Can we make this a Group Roll? I think we could catch each other if we fall.

GM: Absolutely. Make a Group Roll for **88 FORTITUDE**.

FORTITUDE GROUP ROLL

Bob: R2a3 - 8 3

Alice: R5a5 - 1 8 2 5 10

(continued...)

(...continued)

Eve: R6a4 - ③ ⑦ ⑫ ④ ① ②**GM:** Great. Between all of you you have 3 successes. Alice's extra success makes up for Bob's lack of success.

Bob- you stumble in the thick mud and almost land face first, but Alice catches you. You all struggle through and make it through the swamp without injury.

Other examples of situations where group rolls are appropriate include:

- Stealthily getting through a stretch of terrain
- Persuading someone that your group is trustworthy
- A coordinated group performance of any kind
- Crafting a large batch of items or cooking a large meal

2.4 Roll Contests

Sometimes, one character may struggle against another character or entity within the game. When this happens, the game enters a roll contest—both characters roll against each other.

The process of a roll contest is as follows:

1. Both characters make their roll simultaneously.
2. If one character is successful and the other is not, the successful character wins.
3. If both characters are unsuccessful, return to step 1.

4. If both characters are successful, the first character will be penalized dice equal to the number of successes of the second character, and vice versa. Return to step 1.

5. If you have repeated this process to the point where one character has no dice remaining, the character who has dice remaining wins the contest.

6. If both characters reach 0 dice simultaneously, both characters lose the contest (taking any penalties involved with losing the contest).

Step 6 is only important when one of the characters has an ability that imposes a penalty for failing a roll.

Roll Contests are probably best illustrated with an example as follows.

Eve: Can I initiate a grapple on the guard?**GM:** Sure! Go ahead and initiate a Roll Contest with  **ATHLETICS**.**Eve:** I'll use my Dexterity talent since I'm much better at that.**GM:** Sure, you can *talent proxy*. Use Dexterity at 2 additional disadvantage.

ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 1

Eve: R6a2 - ③ ⑤ ⑨ ① ④ ⑤**Guard:** R4a4 - ② ⑧ ③ ②**Eve:** Shoot.**GM:** Don't worry, neither of you have any successes, so you'll roll again.

ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 2

Eve: R6a2 - ⑨ ⑪ ⑦ ② ⑥ ③**Guard:** R4a4 - ⑨ ① ③ ⑩

(continued...)

(...continued)

GM: You grab the guard but he's wriggling out of your grasp. You'll roll with 2 fewer dice since he got 2 successes, and he'll roll with 1 fewer dice because you got 1 success. Go again.

ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 3

Eve: R4a2 - 12 4 1 2

Guard: R3a4 - 4 7 3

Eve: Yes! I succeeded and the guard did not.

GM: Great! You deftly bend the guard's arm and twist him into your awaiting chokehold. You've grappled the guard.

It is highly disrecommended to perform a *Group Roll contest*. For tasks of that complexity it is usually better to let the game enter phased mode- which will be described in detail later.

If you do find yourself in a situation in which a Group Roll contest is called for, the process is as follows.

1. Both groups make their Group Rolls simultaneously..
2. If one group is successful and the other is not, the successful group wins.
3. If both groups are unsuccessful, return to step 1.
4. If both groups are successful, the first group must be penalized a number of dice equal to the second group's number of successes, and vice versa. Every character in the group takes this penalty. Then return to Step 1.
5. If you have repeated this process to the point where one group has no

dice remaining, the group who has dice remaining wins the contest.

6. If both groups reach 0 dice simultaneously, both groups lose the contest (taking any penalties involved with losing the contest).

2.5 Helping Rolls

Sometimes in a situation, a character may be able to help another character perform a task, such as lifting a heavy object, searching for insight into a puzzle, playing a game of chess, putting on a performance, or wrestling an opponent.

When this happens they may roll to help the other character. This is simpler than a Group Roll.

An helping roll is performed as follows:

1. Any character that is able to help and wants to help rolls the same talent or ability as the character making the initial roll.
2. The sum of all participating characters' successes, including the original character, is the number of successes for the original roll.
3. If the roll risks injury on failure, all of the participating characters will receive the injury.

Below is an example of a helping roll.

GM: Large Larry is the only one left, and he is *obstructing* the exit to this room. Player party, it's your offensive phase.

Eve: I'm so done with this fight. Can I just cast gravitate and pull him out of the way?

Bob: I also have gravitate. I can help!

(continued...)

(...continued)

GM: Great, this will be a roll contest between Eve and Large Larry, with Bob helping Eve. Both of you give me your gravitate rolls and Larry will contest with fortitude.

ROLL CONTEST ROUND 1

Eve: R4a4 - 9 3 4 9

Bob: R4a3 - 5 11 10 10

Large: R6a5 - 7 2 1 12 9 1

Larry

GM: Nice rolls. Larry will take $\{-5\}$ next round, Bob and Eve will both take $\{-3\}$ next round.

ROLL CONTEST ROUND 2

Eve: R1a4 - 9

Bob: R1a3 - 4

Large: R1a5 - 4

Larry

GM: Excellent work. You pull Larry out of the way and he is no longer obstructing the exit.

Note that this was a helping roll used in a roll contest. In round 2, both Bob and Eve took the penalty from Larry's successes in round 1, but Larry took the penalties from both Bob and Eve's successes in round 1.

When helping rolls are used for abilities other than base talents, the helping character must in general have and actively use the same ability as the character they are helping.

For instance, to help another character cast a particular spell, the helping character must know the same spell and use the same cast and consume a cast use.

In order to help another character use a specific augment ability, the helping character must have the same augment active in their loadout and use the same ability.

Additionally, to help a character in phased mode who is using an ability that takes an action (offensive or defensive), the helping character must also consume an action to help.

3 Building a Character

The same character building process is used for non-player-characters (NPC's) and player characters (PC's). This chapter will indicate when something is nonessential for a non-player character.

For a step by step overview of the process of building a character, consider skipping to Section 3.8.

3.1 Fundamental Attributes

All characters have 6 fundamental attributes, divided into 3 *Foundations* and 3 *Characteristics*.

- **Foundations**–
Mind, Body, Heart
- **Characteristics**–
Precision, Strength, Grace

The foundations and characteristics are combined to form 9 fundamental *talents* that all characters have.

Table 3a: Combining Foundations and Characteristics to get Talents

	PRECISION	STRENGTH	GRACE
MIND	MEMORY R[MIND]a[PRECISION]	INTELLECT R[MIND]a[STRENGTH]	INSIGHT R[MIND]a[GRACE]
BODY	DEXTERITY R[BODY]a[PRECISION]	FORTITUDE R[BODY]a[STRENGTH]	ATHLETICS R[BODY]a[GRACE]
HEART	PERCEPTION R[HEART]a[PRECISION]	WILL R[HEART]a[STRENGTH]	CHARISMA R[HEART]a[GRACE]

When building a character, you have:

- 6 points to distribute among your foundations ([**MIND**], [**BODY**], [**HEART**]) as you see fit
- 8 points to distribute among your characteristics ([**PRECISION**], [**STRENGTH**], [**GRACE**]) as you see fit

You **must** allocate at least 1 point to each foundation and each characteristic.

The number of points you allocate to each fundamental attribute become the

value of that fundamental attribute for the lifetime of your character and may not be changed after character creation.

However, you can gain aptitude in each of the fundamental talents which give additional advantage to their rolls, and racial bonuses and skills may give you bonus dice on different rolls.

The 12 fundamental talents are meant to intuitively follow from their construction. If you are trying to determine what talents are applicable in a situation, sim-

ply consider:

- Does this situation need Precision, Strength, or Grace?
- Does this situation relate to the Body, the Heart, or the Mind?

Then, find the corresponding row and column on the talent grid, and roll that talent to determine success.

The GM ultimately determines if a talent applies in a narrative situation, and

sometimes there may be more than one talent that is equally applicable. If the player can make an argument that the GM finds reasonable for why a talent is reasonable in a situation, they may roll that talent.

For clarity, what follows are descriptions of all the talents along with some example situations where they apply. This is not a comprehensive list.

• **MEMORY**– Used for any situation that requires Precision of Mind, such as precise recall, exact pattern matching or recognition, or accurate calculation. Examples include:

- A character is trying to recall if they've seen a symbol before in their past
- A character is trying to determine which of two piles of material weighs more
- A character is trying to determine if a language or code they are hearing is one they've heard before.
- A character is trying to memorize instructions for a complex process

• **INTELLECT**– Used for any situation that requires Strength of Mind– such as intense computation or decisions involving many simultaneous variables. Examples include:

- A character is trying to decode a coded message
- A character is coming up with the solution to a puzzle
- A character needs to beat another character in a game of chess

• **INSIGHT**– Used for any situation that requires Grace of Mind, such as nimble thinking or problems requiring the right inspiration to strike in a timely manner. Examples include:

- A character is investigating a crime scene
- A character is trying to invent a mechanism to close a door based on objects strewn around the area
- A character is trying to discern the political motivations of an organization
- A character is trying to escape a trap or legal dilemma

• **DEXTERITY**– Used for any situation that requires Precision of Body– think along the lines of quick and accurate reflexes. Examples include:

- Aiming a ranged weapon at a moving target

(continued...)

(...continued)

- Catching a rapidly moving small object
- Disarming a delicate trap without triggering it
- **FORTITUDE**– Used for any situation that requires Strength of Body– think along the lines of endurance and raw physical power. Examples include:
 - Withstanding the effects of a strong alcoholic drink
 - Carrying a heavy object for a period of time
 - Wading through thick mud or pushing through tangled vines
- **ATHLETICS**– Used for any situation that requires Grace of Body– think along the lines of well developed martial form or postural technique. Examples include:
 - Throwing an object as far as possible
 - Arm wrestling another character
 - Rolling out of a fall to mitigate damage
- **PERCEPTION**– Used for any situation that requires Precision of Heart. This applies to the accuracy of a character’s emotional inspiration. Examples include:
 - Determining if another character is lying
 - Accurately guessing why another character is acting strange
 - Figuring out what is meaningful to another character
- **WILL**– Used for any situation that requires Strength of Heart. This applies to determination and emotional centered-ness. Examples include:
 - A character is trying to withstand a psychic attack (or puppy-dog eyes)
 - A character is trying to power through pain to maintain focus on a task
 - A character is trying to resist the effects of a sedative
- **CHARISMA**– Used for any situation that requires Grace of Heart. This can be thought of the character’s ability to navigate emotional issues and convince other people to follow their lead. Examples include:
 - Persuading another character to give up an item
 - Rallying a crowd to perform an action
 - Deceiving another character about something

3.1.1 Talent Proxying

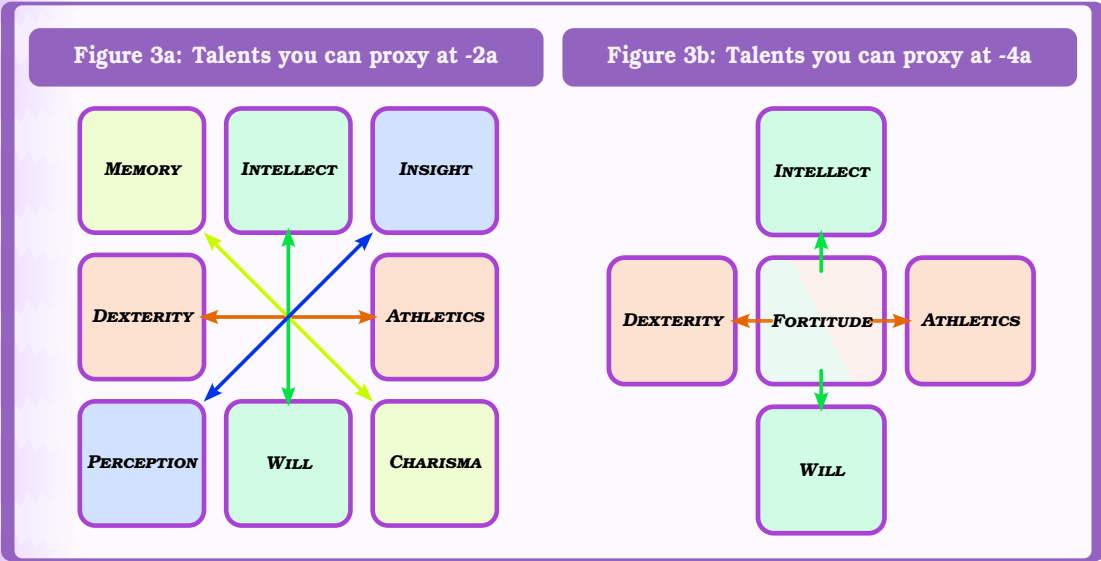
The various talents in ITRP have significant conceptual overlap. In addition to the GM determining what talents are appropriate to a situation, players are allowed to use talents on the opposite side

of the talent grid at 2 additional disadvantage. This is called talent proxying.

This encapsulates the fact that vastly different skills may be used to accomplish the same feat. For instance, the ability to remember details about what motivates people can substitute for the

ability to appeal to their emotions, and in this way, the **MEMORY** talent may proxy for the **CHARISMA** talent. Fast enough reflexes would allow you to adjust your body in the right way to accomplish martial feats that would usually require well developed form. Conversely, well developed form can substitute for fast and accurate reflexes. Therefore **DEXTERITY** and **ATHLETICS** can proxy for each other. **FORTITUDE** may be proxied with ei-

ther **INTELLECT**, **DEXTERITY**, **WILL**, or **ATHLETICS** at 4 additional disadvantage. This represents the fact that physical problem solving (Intellect), accurate enough reflexes (Dexterity), dogged enough determination (Will), or well developed form (Athletics), can all substitute for raw power. What follows are visual diagrams showing what talents can be proxied for others.



You can gain aptitude in your talents by spending experience points, or XP for short. Each aptitude gives 1 additional advantage when rolling the talent. It costs:

- 1 XP for the first aptitude
- 2 XP for the second aptitude
- 3 XP for the third aptitude

You may have a maximum of 3 aptitude in any talent.

3.1.2 Depleting Fundamentals

In a pinch, you may *deplete* your foundations and your characteristics for certain bonuses.

Each time you *deplete* a fundamental, you incur an additional -1 penalty to that fundamental. This penalty persists until you next take the *sleep* downtime action. You may not deplete your foundations or characteristics below 0.

Note that if you deplete your **[MIND]**, **[BODY]**, or **[HEART]** to 0 you will **automatically fail all rolls related to these foundations**. You may still proxy a related talent to avoid failing the roll.

Depleting 2 foundations (**[MIND]**, **[BODY]**, or **[HEART]**) to 0 causes a character to fall *unconscious*. Your character may return to consciousness by having

one of their foundations restored.

Depleting all 3 foundations ([**MIND**], [**BODY**], and [**HEART**]) to 0, *kills* a character. If your character is dead- talents, abilities and items that normally restore foundation depletion will not work, and they must be restored to life by other means.

Any or all of a character's characteristics ([**PRECISION**], [**STRENGTH**], or [**GRACE**]) may be depleted to 0 without penalty.

3.2 Wounds

Each time a character receives a wound, they must choose a foundation ([**MIND**], [**BODY**], or [**HEART**]) to deplete by 1.

Healing wounds in this system is done by abilities that restore depleted foundations.

The **Robust** skill (described in Section 3.7) allows a character to take some wounds before depleting foundations.

3.2.1 Injuries

An injury is a specific type of wound which is applied directly to one specific foundation (one of [**MIND**], [**BODY**], or [**HEART**]).

The GM decides if a task has a risk of injury. Injuries are incurred specifically to the foundation related to the talent used for the failed task.

Failed **MEMORY**, **INTELLECT**, and **INSIGHT** rolls with a risk of injury result in an injury to [**MIND**].

Failed **DEXTERITY**, **FORTITUDE**, and **ATHLETICS** rolls with a risk of injury result in an injury to [**BODY**].

Failed **PERCEPTION**, **WILL**, and **CHARISMA** rolls with a risk of injury result in an injury to [**HEART**].

The Robust skill still protects you from injuries if you have wounds left that can be allocated to the Robust skill.

3.3 Species Bonuses

The species of a character provides bonuses to some of their talents.

The species bonuses are described for each species in Chapter 9.

3.4 Archetypes

Your character has an archetype- a way that their luck tends to run. This consists of a general type of *situation* and the type of *fortune* they have in this situation.

Your character starts with 1 archetype rank, and additional ranks may be added for 3 XP each. You may have a maximum of 5 archetype ranks.

You may choose to accumulate bonus archetype ranks above your usual maximum by *depleting* 1 from Grace for each bonus rank.

Situations:

- **Social**- all circumstances in which the character is trying to influence the actions or words of other characters in the world around them. Recieve +1 to [**GRACE**].
- **Technical**- all circumstances in which the character is trying to create or modify something in the world around them. Recieve +1 to [**PRECISION**].
- **Martial**- all circumstances in which the character is in combat or physical contest (with the environment or another player). Recieve +1 to [**STRENGTH**].

(continued...)

(...continued)

Fortunes:

- **Adept**– For any roll in your situation, you may adjust any die by up to [RANKS] values AFTER rolling.
- **Awkward**– Up to [RANKS] times a day, you may choose to automatically fail a roll in your situation in order to gain 4 bonus dice on your next roll (in any situation).
- **Confident**– Once a day, after making a successful roll in a situation, you may choose to gain 6 advantage for the next [RANKS] consecutive subsequent rolls in that situation. You must do this before seeing the results of any of the subsequent rolls.
- **Duplicitious**– When your character is in a contested roll in the situation, you may swap up to [RANKS] of your rolled dice with your opponent's rolled dice (even if your opponent is inanimate or the environment). Your number of successes still depend on how much advantage you had on your original roll, and your opponent's number of successes still depend on how much advantage they had in their original roll.
- **Judicious**– Roll [RANKS] dice at the beginning of the day. You maintain a pool of [RANKS] dice that starts initially populated by your first rolls. In any archetype situation- you may swap any number of dice in your pool with dice in your roll, AFTER seeing the result.
- **Lucky**– A number of times equal to your number of archetype ranks, you may choose to automatically succeed on a roll in this situation. You must choose to do this before seeing the result of the roll.
- **Oblivious**– Up to [RANKS] times a day in your character's situation, you may ignore a roll and force a reroll, AFTER seeing the result, and you may reverse decisions about whether you used another ability to alter the dice roll before rerolling it.

3.5 Loadout Overview

A character's *loadout* refers to the set of equipment and abilities that they currently have access to. In FRP these are split into three categories: Casts, Augments, and Equipment.

Since there are numerous options for each of the loadout categories, this section will simply describe the function of each loadout category without listing all the options. For more details on various loadout options, skip to Chapter ??.

For NPC's a GM may consider skipping fully defining a loadout. In most sit-

uations an NPC will function even if the loadout has sections that are not defined.

3.5.1 Casts

Casts are special abilities that may be used a limited number of times each day.

A character may only have a fixed number of *prepared casts*. On creation, a character's [MAX PREP] is equal to their [MIND] score. They may prep more casts than this by depleting their [MIND] score by 1 for each additional cast prepared. The [MIND] score depleted by overprepping casts may be restored by unprepping these casts.

In order to prepare a cast, a character must possess a cast focus corresponding to that cast. Most cast focuses are Wt 0 and cost 100 gold. Once a cast focus is in a character's possession it may be used as many times as desired to prepare that cast. A cast focus may be spell notes that a character has written themselves, or a series of runes that they use to imbue themselves with power, or even a device they activate which creates an effect on demand.

A character may only activate any of their prepared casts a fixed number of times between downtimes. On creation, a character's **[MAX CASTS]** is equal to their **[PRECISION]**.

To be clear, all of these cast activations may be due to the same cast being used, but a character may only cast a number of times equal to **[MAX CASTS]** without penalty. They may cast more than their usual max by depleting their **[PRECISION]** by 1 for each time they exceed **[MAX CASTS]**.

Options for casts in the base system are specified in Section 5.

3.5.2 Augments

Augments are devices, implants, or enhanced body features that grant a character extra abilities, which are powered by the intrinsic energy of the character's body or soul.

A character's **[MAX AUGMENTS]**, the number of augments they may have active without penalty, is initially equal to their **[HEART]** score. They may have more active augments than their **[MAX AUGMENTS]** by depleting their **[HEART]** score for one by every additional augment they keep active. The **[HEART]** score depleted by overactivating augments can be restored by deactivating augments over the limit.

Each augment in general gives a character access to one passive ability.

The exception is *attunements* which are special augments that give a char-

acter access to a skill tree that can be invested in with XP. Each attunement counts as **two** augments. Attunements can be very powerful but can be riskier if a character is *disabled* and has to deactivate an attunement, they will lose access to the entire skill tree provided by an augment.

Options for augments in the base system are specified in Section 6

3.5.3 Equipment

On creation, a character's **[EQUIP Wt]**, the total weight of equipment they can have actively equipped is equal to their **[BODY]** score. If a character equips equipment in excess of the **[EQUIP Wt]**, they will *deplete* their **[BODY]** score by 1 for each additional weight unit of equipment they equip. The **[BODY]** score depleted by overequipping equipment may be restored by unequipping the additional equipment.

Equipment is divided into armor and implements. Implements include weapons, tools, and accessories, as well as any other items that may need to be rapidly accessed, manipulated, or wielded during *phased* mode. A character may only have one piece of armor equipment actively equipped. A character may have any number of implweapons, tools and accessories actively equipped as long as the sum of their weights does not exceed the character's **[EQUIP Wt]**.

Only actively equipped items may be accessed without penalty when the game is in *phased* mode.

On creation, a character's **[PACK Wt]**, total weight of things they can have in their personal inventory (aside from equipment you currently have actively equipped) is equal to their **[STRENGTH]** score. Having more weight than this in their inventory will *deplete* their **[STRENGTH]** score by 1 for each additional weight unit of items they have in their inventory. The **[STRENGTH]** score depleted

by carrying too many items may be restored by dropping items in their inventory.

Options for equipment in the base system are specified in Section ??.

3.5.4 Changing Loadout

If you change your loadout of active augments, inventory items, or prepped casts during *phased* (turn-based) gameplay, you will *deplete* your [**GRACE**] score. You may change your actively equipped items without penalty during phased gameplay, but note that pulling items out of your pack to do so will still deplete your [**GRACE**].

You can change any part of your loadout without penalty during *open* (non-turn-based) gameplay however many times you like.

3.6 Languages

Languages may be modified to be setting specific in FRP, but there are 6 languages that are referred to in the base system listed in this section.

A character starts knowing Standard, and depending on your character's species may know one other language by default. Your character may learn a new language by investing 2XP.

- **Standard**– A common language spoken by most sentient creatures. A cultural relic of a vast fallen empire which used to rule the setting.
- **Leesong**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Avian species.
- **Chitter**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Weaver Species.
- **Wake**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Aquatic species.
- **Slewback**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Reptilian species.
- **Prineu**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Homonid species.

The GM may add languages and dialects beyond these to their setting as they see fit

3.7 Skills

Skills are things your character has trained in which confer various benefits. You must invest in skills with XP in order to use them.
It costs:

- 1 XP for the first rank in a skill
- 2 XP for the second rank in a skill
- 3 XP for the third rank in a skill.

Each skill may only be listed once (with the exception of the “Familiarity” skill), and you may have a maximum of 3 ranks in any skill.

What follows are descriptions of all the skills your character can take.

- **Augment Mastery**– for each rank in augment mastery, you may increase your **[MAX AUGMENTS]** by one.
- **Marathon Caster**– for each rank in marathon caster, you may increase your **[MAX CAST ACTIVATIONS]** by one
- **Versatile Caster**– for each rank in versatile caster, you may increase your **[MAX PREPARED CASTS]** by one.
- **Robust**– you may take wounds up to **[RANKS]** in Robust without depleting any of your fundamentals. Once you exceed this number of wounds you will start depleting fundamentals as usual in response to sustaining a wound.
- **Porter**– for each rank in porter, you may increase your **[PACK Wt]** by 1.
- **Walking Armory**– for each rank in Walking Armory, you may increase your **[EQUIP Wt]** by 1.
- **Linguist**– Whenever you must roll for any sort of communication involving a language your character does not know, you may do so with **[RANKS]** additional advantage.
- **Familiarity with [topic]**– pick a topic your character is familiar with. The topic must be much more specific than "social," "martial," or "technical." Whenever your character is rolling in a situation relating to this topic, gain **[RANKS]** bonus dice to your roll. You may take this skill multiple times as long as the topic is unique for each listing.

Examples of topics for Familiarity:

- Unarmed combat
- A specific class of spaceships
- A specific type of magic
- A specific type of weapon
- A specific culture
- A specific technology

The GM of a game can decide if the topic your character has picked is specific enough for the Familiarity skill. If a topic you've already chosen seems too broad after a few sessions of play, the GM can ask you to narrow your topic. If a topic you've chosen seems too narrow after a few sessions of play, you may ask the GM to broaden your topic.

3.8 Character Building Overview section.

For convenience, this section is a consolidated step-by-step guide to building a character. You may follow along with the example character sheet at the end of this

1. Chose your Fundamentals. Your foundations (**[HEART]**, **[BODY]**, and **[MIND]**) should all sum up to 6. Your characteristics (**[PRECISION]**, **[STRENGTH]**, **[GRACE]**) should all sum up to 8. The minimum value

of any of these fundamentals is 1.

2. Choose a species. Apply any bonuses to talents by writing them in the corresponding box labeled with {+}. Take note of any species abilities.
3. Write “Standard” in your languages. If your species gives you another language by default, write this in your languages as well.
4. Set your [**MAX CASTS**] to your [**PRECISION**] score, and set your [**MAX PREP**] to your [**MIND**] score.
5. Set your [**EQUIP Wt**] to your [**BODY**] score, and set your [**PACK Wt**] to your [**STRENGTH**] score.
6. Set your [**MAX AUGMENTS**] to your [**HEART**] score.
7. Start with 12 XP. Invest as you see fit in various abilities, or save them for later.
8. Start with 1000 gold. Invest in equipment as you see fit, or save it for later.
9. Choose a number of wt 0 casts less than or equal to your [**MAX PREP**] and write them in your list of prepped casts. Place corresponding cast focuses in the cast focus section of your Pack.
10. Choose a number of augments less than or equal to your [**MAX AUGMENTS**] and write them in your list of augments.
11. If you have taken the robust skill, you can put the number of skill ranks you have in robust in the smaller box of the “Wounds” section of the character sheet.
12. Discard items of your choice in your pack until the total weight of pack items is less than or equal to [**PACK Wt**].

Character Name

Species

XP

Archetype

Species Abilities

Languages

Used Ranks Bonus

☐ [MAX PREP]

Prepped Casts

☐/☐ [MAX CASTS]

Prepped Casts

Armor

[GRAB LIMBS]

[EQUIP Wt]

Wt Resistance

Parry

Implements

Wt

Implements

Wt

Augments

[MAX AUGMENTS]

[DISABLED]

[WOUNDS]

ROBUST

CHARACTERISTICS

[PRECISION]

[STRENGTH]

[GRACE]

[MIND]

MEMORY

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

INTELLECT

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

INSIGHT

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

[BODY]

DEXTERITY

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

FORTITUDE

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

ATHLETICS

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

[HEART]

PERCEPTION

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

WILL

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

CHARISMA

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

Cast Focuses

Wt

[GOLD]

[PACK Wt]

Items

Wt

Items

Wt

[ACTIONS]

STUDY



TINKER



PRACTICE



DEVELOP



TRAIN



ENHANCE



Skills

Ranks

Skills

Ranks

4 Gameplay

Gameplay in TRP is divided into *open* mode and *phased* mode.

4.1 Open mode

Unless the narrative of the game requires extended sequences of rapid action, it's best to keep the game in *open* mode.

Open mode consists of the GM describing a general setting, and the players asking questions to build on the setting and decide what to do. Whenever there's a questionable chance of success to something the players would like to do, the GM will ask them to make relevant rolls.

This is best illustrated with an example.

GM: As you enter the ruins, you notice the ground change beneath you, from soft dirt to sharp gravel. The sounds of wildlife grow eerily quiet.

Pillars of stone are arranged in a path to the temple, some of them are cracked and fallen. You see the mysterious door described by the pirates, but there's a pillar that has fallen over and is blocking it.

Alice: Huh. Can we see past the broken pillar?

GM: You can! The top half of the door is visible, but you can't see the inset for the key you found earlier.

Eve: I could move the pillar out of the way.

Bob: I could also try to worm my way past the pillar to reach the keyhole.

Eve: Oh! good point, maybe try that first.

Bob: I take the key and try to squeeze my way past the pillar.

GM: This requires grace of body. It's an extremely odd angle, so roll with {*dd2*}

ATHLETICS ROLL

Bob: R2a8{*dd2*} ⇒
R2a6 -  

Bob: Awww, so close.

GM: You try several times, Bob, but you just can't squeeze in the key.

(continued...)

(...continued)

Eve: Let me move it for you, Bob.
Could I lift the pillar up?

GM: Okay- That will require strength of body, and the pillar is incredibly heavy. I'd say it's nearly impossible to perform this task, and it has a risk of injury to body on failure. It would need a roll for  **FORTITUDE** with {*dd8*}.

Alice: I'd like to look for a broken piece of stone or something we could use as a wedge to make that easier. Doesn't seem right to risk getting injured before even starting this dungeon.

GM: Sure! That seems reasonable. Seems like Grace of Mind to find a clever way to use your surroundings to make this task easier. Roll me  **INSIGHT**.

INSIGHT ROLL

Alice: R3a5 -   

GM: Great. Alice you notice that one side of the pillar is resting on the stone base on top of a shard of rock. A strong enough person should be able to knock out that rock and let the pillar roll aside. I'll say this brings down the difficulty of the task to hard- requiring {*dd4*}. You still risk injury on failure.

Alice: I suggest pushing out the rock to Eve.

Eve: I'll take Alice's suggestion.

Bob: Wait! We should all be able to do this together. I can help Eve push that rock.

GM: Sure! Eve give me a  **FORTITUDE** roll, and Bob give me a helping roll.

FORTITUDE ROLL

Eve: R6a4{*dd4*} ⇒
R6a0 -      

Bob: R2a3{*dd4*} ⇒
R2d1 -  

GM: Wow! You both heave at the same time and manage to roll the pillar onto it's side so that there's more space near the door. Bob your earlier frustration with the pillar really comes out here and you help Eve bring it over the edge.

Note the back and forth between the GM and the players in this example. The GM poses a problem to the players- namely that there is a pillar blocking the keyhole to the door. The players propose various solutions to the problem, and can even add to the environment by asking

the GM about things that could plausibly exist.

As a GM, when a player suggests something, it behooves you to find something similar that could possibly work to keep the game going.

Below are some guidelines for assigning additional advantage and disadvantage based on the difficulty of the task:

Table 4a: Additional Advantage Guide

DIFFICULTY	ADDL ADV
Near impossible to fail	{aa8}
Very easy task	{aa6}
Easy task	{aa4}
Task with a few situational advantages	{aa2}
Average Difficulty	{aa0}
Task with a few situational disadvantages	{dd2}
Hard task	{dd4}
Very hard task	{dd6}
Near impossible task	{dd8}

4.1.1 Taking Damage

As the players explore the environment, dangers such as traps or hostile creatures or characters may deal damage to them. The number of wounds a player sustains is equal to the damage dealt.

Damage can be either elemental, physical, or direct.

For elemental and physical damage, armor reduces the amount of damage that a player sustains. Plain armor without resistance reduces amount of damage by the weight of the armor.

Armor can have elemental or physical resistance. Elemental resistance armor reduces elemental damage by an additional 1. Physical resistance armor reduces physical damage by an additional 1.

Armor or other equipment may grant a parry which corresponds to one of the talents. When a character has a parry, this talent allows them to block damage

using that talent. Roll the talent listed by the parry and incoming damage is reduced additionally by your number of successes on the parry roll.

Direct damage is not reduced by armor. A character taking direct damage will take a number of wounds equal to the damage.

Direct damage may also not be parried.

Injuries are also not reduced by armor, and may not be parried.

Incoming damage is also reduced by the amount of cover a character has, which is often only relevant in Phased mode.

4.1.2 Poison and Disease

Poison and disease come in three basic types in ΓRP: Precision poison or disease, Strength poison or disease, and Grace poison or disease.

When poison or disease is applied to a character, it automatically depletes 1 from the corresponding characteristic.

4.1.3 Downtime

Downtime is a special part of *open* gameplay where a character takes care of slower tasks after the action for the day calms down.

Downtime consists of the following for each character:

1. Perform downtime actions - the GM must grant a minimum of 2 downtime actions. They may grant an additional bonus downtime action as appropriate, and rarely may grant 2 bonus downtime actions.
 - If one of your actions is **not RECOVERATE**, deplete **one** Foundation of your choice (Mind, Body, Heart) **in addition** to **not** resetting your depleted fundamentals.
2. Choose character's loadout for the next day.

The possible downtime actions are listed below.

- **STUDY**– Roll  **MEMORY**. Increment your study counter by the number of successes you get. When your study counter hits 12 - you reset it to 0 and create a new wt 0 cast focus of your choice (not automatically prepped).
- **SCAVENGE**– Roll  **INTELLECT**. Gain scavenged loot of value equal to 100 gold times the number of successes you get. Ask your GM what loot you obtain.
- **TINKER**– Roll  **INSIGHT**. Increment your tinker counter by the number of successes you get. When your tinker counter hits 12 you may either
 - Create a new item of craft grade 1
 - Create an upgrade that would increase the craft grade of another item by 1
 - Increase the amount of grade of a previously created upgrade by 1.

Upgrades may be applied immediately or at any point during freeform gameplay. You do not need to finalize the properties of the upgrade until your final application of the upgrade.

- **PRACTICE**– Roll  **DEXTERITY**. Increment your practice counter by the number of successes you get. When your practice counter hits 12, reset it to 0, and you may increase the rank of a skill that has 1 rank to 2 ranks. This may be a skill on either your own character, or on any character that has been nearby who you could have been practicing with.
- **DEVELOP**– Roll  **FORTITUDE**. Increment your Development counter by the number of successes you get. When your Development counter hits 12, reset it to 0 and grant yourself or any other player character close to you 1 XP.
- **TRAIN**– Roll  **ATHLETICS**. Increment your Training counter by the number of successes you get. When your Training counter hits 12, reset it to 0 and you may add 1 rank to a Skill that has no ranks in it. This may be a skill on either your own character, or on any character that has been nearby for significant periods of time who you ostensibly could have been practicing with.
- **EXPLORE**– Roll  **PERCEPTION**. If successful, Roll from the exploration table to determine a new area that your character discovers. You may adjust your table roll by a number up to the number of successes you got on the exploration roll.
- **ENHANCE**– Roll  **WILL**. Increment your Enhance counter by the number of successes you get. When your Augmentation counter hits 12, reset it to 0 and either
 - Add a new augment to your character or any nearby willing character.
 - Replace an augment on a character (yours or any nearby willing) with a different augment

(continued...)

(...continued)

- Replace two augments with an attunement on your own character or any nearby willing character.
- Replace an attunement with another attunement or two augments, on your own character or any nearby willing character. The affected character loses any XP invested in the original attunement.
- **SOCIALIZE**– Roll  **CHARISMA**. For each success on your roll, you may either
 - Obtain a piece of plot information from gossip or news.
 - Start a rumour that will reach a specific NPC your character is aware of.
 - Make an NPC who is negative towards your party neutral towards your party.
 - Make an NPC who is neutral towards your party positive towards your party.

You may not adjust the attitude of an NPC who is explicitly hostile towards your party.

- **SHOP**– Ask the GM if this action is available. Purchase equipment and sell equipment. By default, equipment sells for 50% of the price of new equipment. You may roll  **PERCEPTION** to find bargains and decrease the price of buying a piece of new equipment by 10% per success on your perception roll. You may roll  **CHARISMA** to sell your old equipment for higher prices and increase the price of selling a piece of equipment by 10% per success on your charisma roll.
- **CELEBRATE**– Ask the GM if this action is available. This action requires two or more player characters to perform this same action during the same downtime. The next day, all participating player characters will 1 bonus rank to their archetype.
- **RECUPERATE**– Consumes the equivalent of 1 ration. Your character eats and sleeps (if applicable) and tends to their wounds. Perform the following:
 1. Reset any depleted fundamentals.
 2. Clear all wounds
 3. Reset cast uses
 4. Reset loadout change uses
 5. Reset uses of an archetype
 6. Reset bonus ranks in an archetype.

4.2 Phased mode

When performing time sensitive tasks or entering contests or combat, the game enters phased mode.

The GM rotates through different phases where one party is on offense and the other parties are on defense. The GM chooses which party starts on offense based on who initiated the combat.

Defenders choose their reactions first during a turn, and then offense chooses their actions. If one particular character initiated combat with action of any kind, that action occurs before the defenders choose their reactions.

The players within a party may choose their actions and reactions in any order, and do not need to wait until one player has completed all possible actions before performing their own.

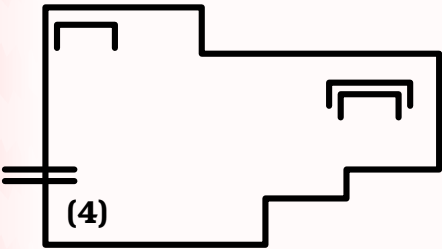
4.2.1 The Arena

When the game enters phased mode the GM must specify an arena. The arena rules are designed to be able to quickly generate unique scenarios.

An arena consists of 1 or more rooms. Each room contains

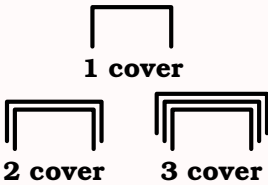
- 1 or more spaces
- 0 or more cover spots
- 1 or more connections to other rooms
- 0 or more exits from the arena

Figure 4a: Room Diagram Example



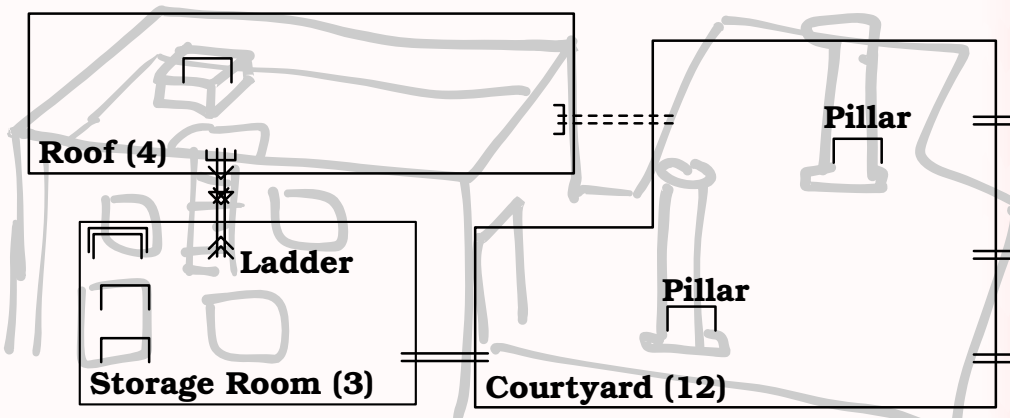
Rooms are shown by right-angled shapes around an area. The number of spaces in a room is indicated by a number in parentheses in a corner.

Figure 4b: Symbols for Cover Spots



You may optionally sketch the actual physical layout that you're trying to get the players to visualize as in the example that follows.

Figure 4c: An example schematic diagram of an arena



Characters have tokens or coins that represent them that can be moved from room to room, or placed on a cover spot, to indicate where they are physically.

A room can be entered even if it is at capacity, but at the end of each phase, if there are more characters than spaces in the room, the GM chooses characters that are not in covered spots to be pushed out of the room by the action until there are only as many characters in the room as there are spaces.

Characters in covered spots may remain in a room even if the room is over capacity.

It takes a movement action to get into or out of a cover spot. A cover spot can only be entered if it is unoccupied. Characters not in a cover spot move freely within the room without a move action.

A character behind cover has any incoming damage reduced by the amount of cover.

Connections are drawn between rooms with a double line. A connection which leads to open space rather than another room indicates an exit from the arena.

Below are some ways you can vary the connection in a diagram.

Table 4b: Connection Symbols

SYMBOL	DESCRIPTION
	Plain connection that takes 1 movement to traverse.
	Visual only- provides line of sight, no traversal.
	1 extra move action to traverse in this direction. <i>N</i> arrows indicate <i>N</i> extra move actions are required.
	1 cover from this room for line of sight. <i>N</i> stacked cover symbols indicate <i>N</i> cover.
	A hazard is present when moving in this direction. If not intentionally moved in this direction, a character (or object) will take 1 damage. <i>N</i> concentric triangles indicate <i>N</i> damage.

(table continues...)

SYMBOL	DESCRIPTION
	A trap is present when traversing this connector. <i>N</i> concentric squares around this symbol indicate <i>N</i> damage.

The trap symbol may also be placed in a room.

Figure 4d: Symbols for Traps



1 damage trap



2 damage trap



3 damage trap

Traps outside a connector act like cover spaces- they require a movement to step into, and on moving into a trap, they deal the amount of damage indicated. The type of damage dealt depends on the type of trap. The GM may write P, E, or D next to a trap to indicate that it deals physical, elemental, or direct damage respectively.

A character encountering a trap must roll  **DEXTERITY**. The damage a trap deals is reduced by the number of successes on the Dexterity roll.

Armor protects against trap damage unless the trap deals direct damage. Characters may also Parry physical or elemental damage from a trap.

Note that if your players are creative with their surroundings, you may end up adding, changing, or removing rooms, connections, hazards, and traps as the turn-based gameplay progresses!

The fastest way to generate an arena is collaboratively- when an arena is needed,

the GM should describe the rooms and connectors, and the players should help draw what the GM is describing.

4.2.2 Ranges

Every action a character can perform has a range.

Single Target Ranges

- **Self**- Only affects the character performing the action
- **Touch**- Affects any one target in the same room as the character
- **Reach**- Affects any one target within the same room as the character, or any adjacent rooms connected directly to the current room.
- **Line-of-sight**- Affects any one target the character has line-of-sight to.
- **Awareness**- Affects any one target the character has recently been aware of via any of their senses.

Area of Effect Ranges

- **Room**- Affects all objects and characters within the room.
- **Connected Rooms**- Affects all objects and characters in this room and all connected rooms
- **Map**- Affects all objects and characters within the current map.
- **Line-of-sight Room**- Affects all objects and characters in any one room the character has line of sight to.

Ranges are particularly relevant in

phased mode, but may be applicable in other scenarios as well.

4.2.3 Offense

Each character can take 3 offensive actions during each offensive phase.

They may choose freely from any offensive actions available to them and perform one of the options multiple times if they want.

Your possible actions are:

- Interact

- Apply talent
- Move
- Attack
- Obstruct
- Use other ability or item that is labeled “as an action” or “as an offensive action”

A description of each of these options follows:

- **Interact** *Touch range*– Flip a switch, pull a lever, pick up an object, drop an object, or perform any other interaction that does not require a talent roll.
- **Apply Talent** *Touch range*– Directly apply one of the character's talents to any target within the room.
- **Move** *Self range*– Move this character. Typically one move action is required to move from one room to another, but depending on the arena, additional movement may be needed.
- **Attack**– Attack, either using a tool/weapon, or your body.

When taking the attack action, you may make as many attacks as it takes to use all your [**GRAB LIMBS**] (the number of prehensile limbs your character has). Some attacks may use up more than one of your limbs to use. Your options are:

- **Weapon Attack**– for each attack action, a character may only attack once with each weapon they have currently equipped. Weapons have an associated talent to use them, and weapons have a minimum or maximum number of limbs you may use to attack.
A weapon attack roll involves rolling the associated talent, with bonus dice equal to the power of the weapon, and additional advantage equal to the number of limbs used to attack.
The number of successes on your roll indicates the amount of damage you do, and the type of damage is dependent on the weapon.
- **Barehanded Attack** *Touch range*– Choose a number of limbs you are going to make a single attack with. Roll $\otimes\otimes\text{FORTITUDE}_{aa[\text{LIMBS}]}$.
The number of successes on your roll indicates the amount of physical damage you do.
- **Grapple** *Touch range*– Involves any maneuver meant to move another character against their will. This involves a roll contest where a character rolls $\otimes\otimes\text{ATHLETICS}$ and the target contests with $\otimes\otimes\text{FORTITUDE}$. A character within cover cannot initiate a grapple, but a character outside cover may initiate a grapple with a character within cover.

(continued...)

(...continued)

If you win the contest, you may force the target to make a single move action of your choice.

Additional forced movement requires additional grapple actions.

- **Disable Touch range**– Impair another character from accessing their augments for the rest of phased mode. This could involve attacking a pressure point or critical point meant to prevent the flow of energy to a character's augments.

The initiating character rolls  **DEXTERITY** and the target contests with  **FORTITUDE**.

If you win the contest, the target's [MAX AUGMENTS] is temporarily reduced by 1 and they must choose augments to temporarily disable until they are below their new [MAX AUGMENTS]. Their [MAX AUGMENTS] is restored to normal as soon as Phased mode ends.

- **Obstruct self range**– The character blocks one connector attached to the room they are in. They must be forced to make a Move action or be rendered incapacitated before anyone else can travel through that connector. This is generally indicated by placing your character token on top of the connector on the side of the room.

4.2.4 Defense

When you are defending, each character in the defending party must choose one reaction.

Your possible reactions are:

- Protect
- Retaliate
- Obstruct
- Dodge
- Use other ability or item that is labeled "as a defensive reaction"

For each of these, you must also specify your reaction trigger. Your choices of trigger are:

- the start of the phase
- an action taken targeting another character
- an action taken targeting your character
- an action taken by another character
- a character entering a room
- a character exiting a room

A description of each of the options follows:

- **Protect**– chose any one character or object within the same zone as this character. Once triggered, the first time an action is taken against the character or object being protected, the action is made to target the protecting character instead of its initial target. You can indicate what is being protected by placing the protecting character's token half way over the target. If multiple characters take the protect reaction on a single target, they may choose between themselves in what order they protect when triggered.
- **Retaliate**– you may take one non-movement offensive action (as in the

(continued...)

(...continued)

offense phase) in response to the trigger.

- **Obstruct**– In response to the trigger, you block one connector. You must be forced to make a Move action or be rendered incapacitated before anyone else can travel through that connector. This is generally indicated by placing your character token on top of the connector on the side of the room.
- **Dodge**– you may take one movement action in response to the trigger.

On a tabletop- you have the choice of sharing your defensive action with the

GM or of writing it on a card and turning it face down

5 Casts

Casts are generally divided into spells, charms, and hexes.

Spells are casts that produce immediate, momentary effects.

Charms are casts that produce lasting continuous effects.

Hexes are casts that sit dormant after casting until triggered, and then produce a momentary effect.

Casts are grouped in this chapter by the weight of their cast focus. More powerful casts have heavier cast foci.

The price of a cast focus is $100 \times 10^{|\text{Wt}|}$

All casts have an associated talent you must roll for the cast to perform its intended action. This cast roll occurs at the time of casting. All casts take one action to cast by default.

When casts are applying magic directly to an unwilling target, the target may resist with a castparry.

The process of a castparry is as follows:

1. Note if the cast specifies a talent to parry with. If left unspecified, the talent is assumed to be **FORTITUDE**.
2. For cast effects that happen immediately- a castparry is equiv-

alent to the target and caster entering a roll contest- the caster's cast roll contested by the target's relevant talent. If the caster wins the contest- the successes on the last roll of the contest are their number of successes for the cast roll.

3. For delayed cast effects, the target simply rolls their relevant talent and reduces the number of successes on the caster's cast roll by the number of successes (very much like an attack parry). If the number of successes is reduced to 0 or less, the cast has no effect.

Castparries only apply when the magic is being directly applied to the target. Casts that produce an effect in the environment which must then be interpreted or resisted may require other talents to do so.

5.1 Wt 0 Casts

This section is all casts with a cast focus of wt 0. All of these are valid casts for your character to start with at character creation. Cast focuses with wt0 all cost 100 gold.

Table 5a: All Casts with a Wt 0 focus

(continued...)

(...continued)

AGILIFY [AGIL]	<i>Charm</i>	Touch	 INSIGHT
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For the rest of this phase, the target of this spell gains a number of free movement actions that do not take an action (even if the target is in defensive phase).
The number of movement actions the target gains is equal to the number of successes on your cast.
In open mode the target gains bonus dice equal to the number of successes on the next talent roll related to moving quickly. This benefit lasts for 10 minutes.

ANALYZE MATERIAL [ANLZ]	<i>Charm</i>	Touch	 PERCEPTION
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For each success, the caster may understand the distribution of one element within the object they have charmed, and how it changes over time. This effect lasts for 10 minutes or until the end of phased mode.
For more than 6 successes, the caster understands the exact elemental composition of the object they have cast analyze on. They are also aware of any changes (physical or elemental) within the object.
The caster must be familiar with the elements in question, otherwise the spell just reveals that there is an unknown element.

CORDIALITY CHARM [CORC]	<i>Charm</i>	Room	 CHARISMA
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Applies to all characters in the current room. These characters receive additional advantage equal to the number of successes on your cast roll on any rolls intended to ingratiate themselves to someone.
This charm lasts for 10 minutes or until the end of a phased mode scene, whichever comes first.

DEFLECTION [DFLC]	<i>Hex</i>	Touch	 INTELLECT
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When the target next takes damage, damage is reduced by the number of successes on your cast roll.

ENNERVATE [ENVT]	<i>Spell</i>	Touch	 INSIGHT
----------------------------	--------------	-------	--

Drains a target's magic.
For every 2 successes, you may force the target to either immediately consume 1 cast use, OR disable 1 augment slot.

FIRE BURST [FBST]	<i>Spell</i>	Room	 ATHLETICS
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Emit waves of fire from your character that can fill the room. Inflict elemental damage on everything in the room of any amount up to your number of successes on the cast roll.
This cast may not be castparried- but as it creates a temporary elemental hazard in the room- ordinary armor and parries apply.

(continued...)

(…continued)

GRAVITATE

[GRAV]

Spell

Line-of-Sight

 **WILL**

If successful, either pull the target towards you the equivalent of 1 move action, or push the target away from you the equivalent of 1 move action. This cast may be castparried with  **FORTITUDE**.

ILLUSORY NOISE

[NOIS]

Charm

Touch

 **MEMORY**

Produce any sound your character is capable of imagining, as long as 10 minute in length or until the end of a phased mode scene. More successes give higher fidelity to the noise. The noise may be produced from anywhere within the current room.

If trying to deceive another character about the source of the sound, contest your cast roll against the other character's  **PERCEPTION**. For longer sounds, the GM may rule multiple roll contests are needed to keep someone or something fooled.

ILLUSORY IMAGE

[IMAG]

Charm

Touch

 **MEMORY**

Produce a 3 dimensional moving image of anything your character is capable of imagining, which is visible for up to 10 minutes or until the end of a phased mode scene. The image must fit within a small room, and must be produced within the current room. More successes give a higher fidelity image.

If trying to deceive another character that the image is a real object, contest your cast roll against the other character's  **PERCEPTION**. For longer durations, the GM may rule multiple roll contests are needed to keep someone or something fooled.

INTOXICATE

[ITOX]

Spell

Touch

 **FORTITUDE**

Poisons a target. Choose between **[PRECISION]**, **[STRENGTH]**, or **[GRACE]** for your poison.

If successful, you inflict an amount of poison of your choice on the target equal to your successes.

LIGHTNING BOLT

[LBLT]

Spell

Line-of-sight

 **DEXTERITY**

You shoot a bolt of lightning at your target, who takes elemental damage equal to the successes on your roll.

This cast may not be castparried- but as it creates a temporary elemental hazard- ordinary armor and parries apply.

IMPLOSION

[IMPL]

Spell

Touch

 **INTELLECT**

Produce a microscopic amount of void-like substance which immediately consumes itself and releases a concussive force that deals physical damage to the target equal to the successes on your roll.

(continued…)

(...continued)

REDIRECT MAGIC [RDCT]	<i>Hex</i>	<i>Touch</i>	 CHARISMA
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A hex that redirects casts away from their intended target.
Cast on a target, and choose whether you wish to try to nullify their next cast or choose a specific target within the same room as you to try to redirect their cast to.
The next time the target makes a cast, their number of successes is reduced by the number of successes you have on redirect magic.
If their number of successes is less than your number of successes on this hex, the cast is redirected to your chosen target.

TELEPATHIC LINK [TLNK]	<i>Charm</i>	<i>Room</i>	 WILL
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Establishes a telepathic link between a number of targets up to the number of successes on your cast roll, as long as they are in the same room as you at the time of casting.
While the link is active, any sound or visual experienced by any of the linked targets may be relayed to the others in the link so that they also experience the sound or visual.
If any of the targets are unwilling, you must first contest with those target's  **WILL** (one target contests and the others roll helping rolls). If successful, your successes on the last roll are the number of successes on for this cast, and the unwilling targets you previously chose must be one of the targets allocated to the successes.
Telepathic Link lasts until next downtime unless dispelled.

TRACE MAGIC [TRCE]	<i>Spell</i>	<i>Touch</i>	 PERCEPTION
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Tells the caster information about magic recently performed on the target or by the target. More successes reveal more information. Can tell you if the target is under the effects of a charm or hex.
In general- the number of successes on the spell roll determine how many casts or effects on the target you get information about, and higher level casts or other magic may require more than 1 success per item to get information.
If cast in an area where someone has died, you can use this to detect the residue of their soul.

5.2 Wt 1 Casts

This section is all casts with a cast focus of wt 1. Your character may not start with

these casts unless purchased with starting money. Cast focuses with wt1 all cost 1000 gold.

Table 5b: All Casts with a Wt 1 Focus

(continued...)

(…continued)

CONTROL AIR

[CAIR]

Spell/Charm

Room

 **DEXTERITY**

For each success on your cast roll, produce one of the following effects:

- Purify enough unbreathable air to last a single character 1 minute.
- Move a volume of air the size of a room or smaller. If directly causing damage with the moved air, it can at most induce movement the equivalent of 1 move action or cause one point of elemental damage (indirect damage causing by influencing other environmental objects is at the GM's discretion).
- Dampen or amplify sounds as much as you see fit within this room for up to 10 minutes (as long as you do not amplify sounds to the point where they could conceivably cause damage). This effect is a charm unlike the other two control air effects, and so may be dispelled.

When inducing movement in an unwilling target, the target may reduce any induced movement by the number of successes on a  **FORTITUDE** roll (note this applies like a parry, not like a roll contest).

CONTROL STONE

[CSTN]

 **FORTITUDE**

For each success on your cast roll, you may do one of the following:

- Move a volume of stone the size of your character or less that is not attached to other stone. When moving stone like this, it may at most induce movement the equivalent of 1 move action, or deal 1 physical damage directly as a cause of this spell (indirect damage causing by influencing other environmental objects is at the GM's discretion).
- Fragment a volume of stone the size of your character or less (such as breaking it apart, or into dust or sand or gravel).
- Fuse a volume of fragmented stone the size of your character or less (sand, dust, or gravel) the size of your character or less into a solid mass.

The total damage done by this spell all acts as a single damage source for the sake of any damage reduction.

When inducing movement in an unwilling target, the target may reduce the total induced movement by the number of successes on a  **FORTITUDE** roll (note this applies like a parry, not like a roll contest).

The farthest you can move the stone with a single use of this spell is one room away from the current.

(continued…)

(...continued)

CONTROL WATER [CWTR]	<i>Spell</i>	Room	 ATHLETICS
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For each success on your cast roll, you may do one of the following:

- Purify an amount of water enough to last a single character 1 day.
- Move a volume of water the size of a room or less in such a way that it at most deals 1 physical damage directly as a cause of this spell (indirect damage causing by influencing other environmental objects is at the GM's discretion)
- Move a volume of water the size of a room or less in such a way that it causes movement at most the equivalent of 1 move action.
- Change the state of a volume of water the size of a room or less (between ice, steam, and liquid water) in such a way that it at most deals 1 elemental damage directly as a cause of this spell (indirect damage causing by influencing other environmental objects is at the GM's discretion)

When inducing movement in an unwilling target, the target may reduce the total induced movement by the number of successes on a  **FORTITUDE** roll (note this applies like a parry, not like a roll contest).

The total volume of water you modify with any use of this spell must be less than or equal to the size of a small room.

The farthest you can move the water with a single use of this spell is one room away from the current.

CURE [CURE]	<i>Spell</i>	Room	 INTELLECT
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Remove a number of wounds or depleted fundamentals (foundations OR characteristics) equal to the number of successes on your cast roll.

DISPEL CAST [DSPL]	<i>Spell</i>	Touch	 INSIGHT
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Immediately end the effect of any one charm or hex. Your number of successes must be higher then the number of successes on the original cast you are trying to dispel.

If the charm or hex in question is on a target who is unwilling to have the cast dispelled- the target may castparry with  **WILL**

LIFE TRACE [LFTR]	<i>Spell</i>	Touch	 PERCEPTION
-----------------------------	--------------	-------	---

Gives the caster information about what maximum fundamentals a target has. Reveals one fundamental and whether it is depleted for each success on life trace.

On any success, also reveals the target's species to the caster.

If an unwilling target castparries this- the

(continued...)

(...continued)

PRECOGNITION

Spell

Touch

 **MEMORY**

[PCOG]

Gives the target a brief glimpse of what will happen when they take their next action. Add the successes on your cast roll as additional advantage on the target's next roll of any kind. If used before a roll contest - this additional advantage only applies to the first roll in the contest.

STASIS

Charm

Touch

 **WILL**

[STAS]

Freeze either an object or the consequences of an action into the future a number of minutes up to the number of successes on your roll.
Target an object or another cast or another action that is about to be taken within the same phase as this cast. If targetting a cast or action and the action or cast does not occur for whatever reason, this cast fails.
If targetting an unwilling character or targetting an action or cast being taken by an unwilling character- the character may castparry with  **DEXTERITY**.
Stasised objects and actions can be detected via trace magic, and dispelling the charm brings them out of stasis.

SOULSHOCK

Spell

Touch

 **CHARISMA**

[SSHK]

Contest your cast roll against the target's  **WILL**. Inflict direct damage equal to your number of successes on your final roll.

5.3 Wt 2 Casts

This section is all casts with a cast focus of wt 2. Your character may not start with

these casts unless purchased with starting money. Cast focuses with wt2 all cost 10,000 gold.

Table 5c: All Casts with a Wt 2 Focus

(continued...)

(...continued)

BIOMORPH [BMRF]	<i>Charm</i>	<i>Touch</i>	 ATHLETICS
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Produce one of the following effects, targetting characters only:

- For every 2 successes on the cast roll, any living target gains 1 specific species ability of the caster’s choice.
- For every 3 successes on the cast roll, the target has their body features altered to appear as if they are another species that the caster is familiar with.
- For every 4 successes on the cast roll, the target fully transforms species or sex to that of the caster’s choice (it would take 8 successes to change species **and** sex, except for species that do not have distinct biological sexes).

These effects all last 10 minutes before expiring, and the target goes back to their previous state.

If cast on an unwilling target, the caster must contest their cast roll with the target’s  **FORTITUDE**. If successful, the number of successes on the caster’s final roll count as the number of successes for this charm.

In general, a GM should not allow a player character to be modified by any NPC’s or other players without their consent.

CONJURE [CNJR]	<i>Spell</i>	<i>Touch</i>	 FORTITUDE
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Produce a quantity of a specific form of an element from ambient Essentia.

- For Primary elements (stone, water, air, metal)- you can conjure 100g per success on your cast roll
- For Noble elements (things necessary for life)- you can conjure 10g per success
- For Higher elements you can conjure 1g per success or less at the GM’s discretion.

Your character must be familiar with the element to produce it, and your con-jured element may be in any three dimensional shape you desire.

You can use this to conjure void, but the effect is identical to the **IMPLOSION** spell.

Of note- a single gold piece is 100 grams. This spell is not a convenient way to generate money.

(continued...)

(…continued)

ENCHANT

[ENCH]

Spell

Touch

 **INSIGHT**

Target any hex or charm within range.

If targetting a hex, it may now be triggered multiple times before it expires- a number of times equal to the number of successes on your cast roll for Enchant. However any conditions, secondary casts, and the number of successes on the original hex are all locked and may not be changed by the original caster between repetitions.

If targetting a charm- it repeats the exact effects it had when it was cast when it would otherwise expire. This repetition happens a number of additional times equal to the number of successes on your cast roll for Enchant.

FABRICATE

[FABR]

Spell

Touch

 **INTELLECT**

If you have a broken object in front of you that you fully understand the function and construction of, and you have the constituent elements of any missing components immediately available, you may restore this object to full function in a single action. The number of successes on your roll must be greater than or equal to the craft grade of the object being repaired.

If the number of successes is not equal to the craft grade of the object being repaired, this spell destroys components of the object such that you must procure its parts again before retrying.

If the object is not something your character created themselves, it is up to the GM if your character is familiar enough with the object to simply repair it, or if it will require a separate  **MEMORY** roll to see if your character would be have knowledge of it.

You can also use this spell to apply previously crafted upgrades to equipment within a single action during phased mode- the number of successes for this must be equal to the craft grade of the final product, and on failure, the upgrade is destroyed and must be produced again.

FEYSTEP

[FSTP]

Spell

Self

 **DEXTERITY**

Your character steps through fey space, instantly teleporting a distance.

Instantly take the equivalent of a number of move actions equal to the number of successes on your cast roll.

When counting move actions, you may bypass obstructions and traps as if they are not there, and travel along visual only connectors on a map. Additionally, all connectors only take one move action to pass, even if they have arrows indicating traversing them normally would require extra move actions.

(continued…)

(...continued)

INSTACAST [INST]	<i>Spell</i>	Touch	PERCEPTION
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This cast has no effect unless you must cast this immediately after another cast occurs in the same room or another character takes an action. Roll for this cast, and then roll for a secondary cast (consuming another cast use for your secondary cast). The secondary cast goes into effect at the same time as the last cast or action made in the same room. If the secondary cast is a hex or charm it goes into effect just BEFORE the previous cast or action completes. The number of successes on your secondary cast is whichever is the smaller between your successes on this cast and your secondary cast roll.

POWERCAST [PWRC]	<i>Spell</i>	Self	WILL
----------------------------	--------------	------	--

Roll your cast roll for powercast, then roll for a secondary cast a number of times up to the number of successes on Powercast. For each re-roll of the secondary cast you must also use consume a cast use (but you do not use additional actions to do so). The successes on all of your rolls for that secondary cast are added together and count as the number of successes for a single cast of that secondary cast.

REACTIONHEX [RCTN]	<i>Hex</i>	Touch	MEMORY
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Sets off another cast conditionally. May be cast on any object, creature, or on a room itself. Choose any trigger as if you're choosing a trigger for a Defensive reaction in Defensive phase, with the restriction that the trigger must be something that occurs within the same room as the target. Cast a secondary cast. This secondary cast only goes into effect when your specified trigger for this cast happens. The target of the secondary cast may depend on the trigger, but any secondary effects must be chosen at the time of casting reactionhex. The number of successes on your secondary cast is whichever is smaller between your successes on this cast and your secondary cast roll. If casting on an unwilling target, you must contest with the target's  **FORTITUDE**. Your number of successes on this roll is equal to your successes on the last roll of the contest.

SUMMON [SUMN]	<i>Spell</i>	Awareness	CHARISMA
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Instantly move any target you are aware of to a location of your choice within the current room. A target you can currently detect with any of your senses only takes 1 success to summon. A target you know about but cannot currently detect with your senses takes 1 additional success to summon. A distant target takes 1 additional success per kilometer of distance.

5.4 Gamma Cast Notation

For more complicated casts with chained secondary casts, it is useful to have a shorthand way to notate effects so that the players and the GM do not have to remember the exact effect.

The suggested shorthand is Gamma Cast Notation which is described in this section. Gamma Cast Notation is designed to be quick to write on pen and paper as well as quick to type into a textbox.

<DFLC 3>

^<ENCH 4>

5.5 Common Use Cases

Bringing a deceased character back to life when the body is present- conjure to replace any critical missing tissue, trace magic to find the character's soul residue within the ambient essentia, summon to bring the soul you are now aware of back into their body.

When the body is not present, you can conjure an approximate body made of ectoplasm and bring soul into that- this would create a ghost.

block casting in an area- reactivecast whenever a cast is made - secondary cast is instacast redirect magic into nothing. You can Enchant to make it applicable multiple times.

6 Augments

This chapter contains augments and attunements. Augments may often be left off quickly generated NPC's.

Augments and attunements may not be added or changed after character creation, except via the *Enhance* downtime action.

Your character may only have one of each type of augment (or attunement) active. Duplicate augments or attunements are not allowed, even if any custom prop-

erties are different.

6.1 Augments

Below is a table of all augments within the system.

For GM's creating custom augments-limit each augment to modifying 1 other basic character mechanic in a passive way.

Table 6a: All non-attunement augments

AUGMENT	DESCRIPTION
BUILT-IN ARMOR	Choose any armor with craft grade 2. As long as this augment is active, your character has the equivalent of this armor whenever they are not wearing other armor. Unless they are being attacked the armor is not necessarily visible. This does not count towards equip Wt. This may take the form of implanted plates of hardened material, magical force that repels attacks, or any other body modification that could conceivably act as armor.
BUILT-IN WEAPON	Choose any weapon with craft grade 2. As long as this augment is active, your character has the equivalent of this weapon equipped. Unless your character is actively attacking with it, the weapon is not necessarily visible. This does not count towards equip Wt. This may take the form of a retractable claw, a magical spectral ghost weapon that pops into existence, or any other body modification that could conceivably act as a weapon.

(table continues...)

AUGMENT	DESCRIPTION
CANTRIP	Choose one particular wt0 focus cast to assign to this augment. A character may use this cast even if not prepared, without consuming a cast use, as long as this augment is active. For storytelling purposes this augment can take the form of a runic tattoo, a piece of magic jewelry, or anything you can come up with that would store a magic spell without your character having to specifically cast the spell with their mind.
FLAIR	As long as this augment is active, receive {+1} to all rolls where you are trying to get someone to support you in a social situation.
SURE FEET	As long as this augment is active: in phased mode you take one less move action to traverse any connector that takes more than one move action to traverse. In open mode, receive {+1} to any rolls that involve navigating the environment.
CRAFTY MIND	As long as this augment is active, receive {+1} to all rolls involving crafting, repairing, or modifying something.
HEX AMPLIFIER	As long as this augment is active, receive {+2} to all cast rolls for hexes.
CHARM AMPLIFIER	As long as this augment is active, receive {+2} to all cast rolls for charms.
SPELL AMPLIFIER	As long as this augment is active, receive {+1} to all cast rolls for spells.
SPECTRAL HAND	Provides a transparent floating not-necessarily-species-specific prehensile limb that is bound to stay within 1 m of your character’s heart. As long as this augment is active - increase your [GRAB LIMBS] by 1 It may also be useful for reaching into tight spaces at the GM’s discretion.

6.2 Attunements

Each Attunement takes 2 augment slots. All attunements have four tiers roughly as follows:

- Tier 0** Applies benefits at this tier as soon as the character takes the attunement.
- Tier 1** Invest 1XP to gain each Tier 1 benefit.
- Tier 2** After gaining at least 1 Tier 1 ben-

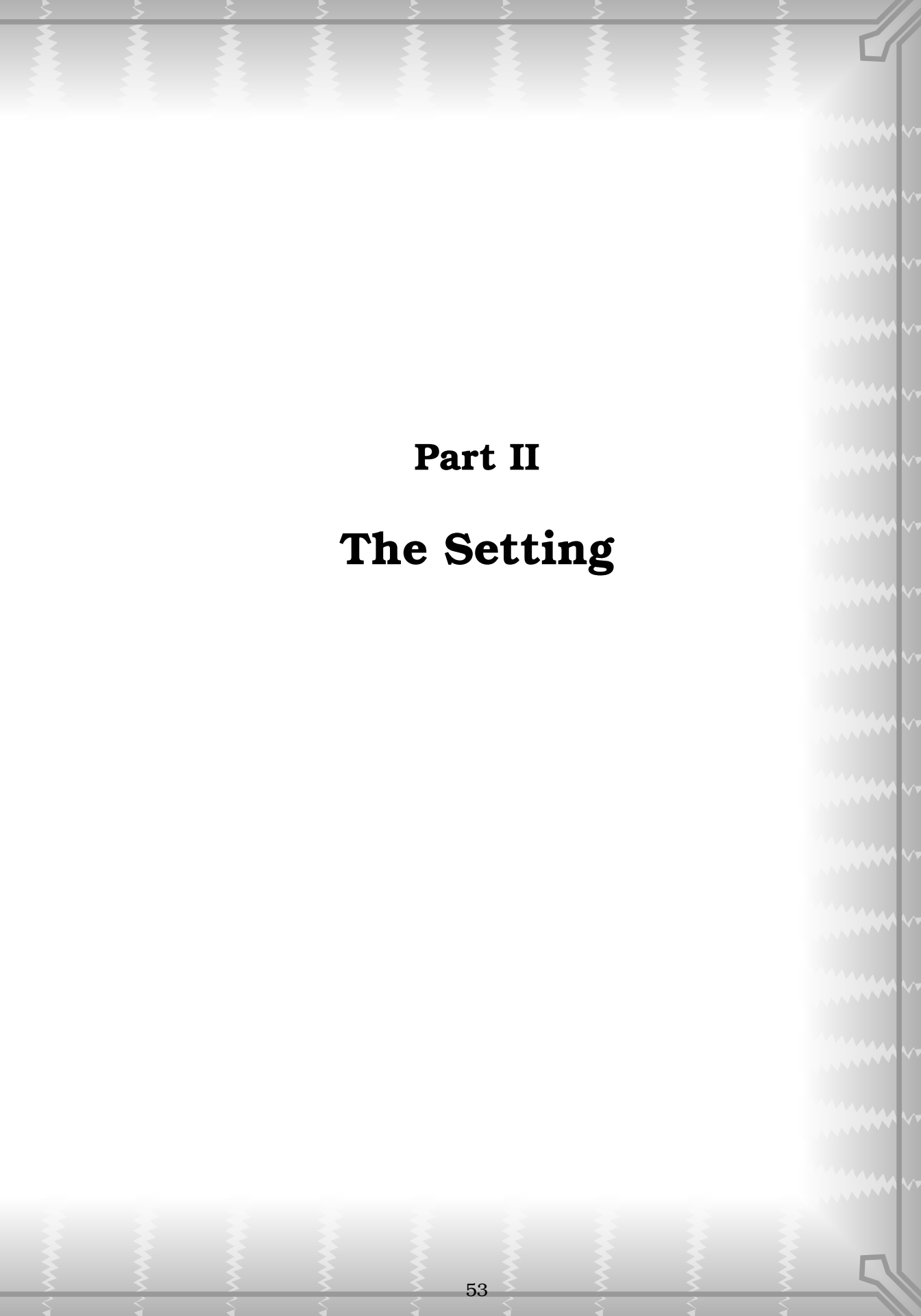
efit, you may invest 2XP to gain each Tier 2 benefit.

Tier 3 After gaining at least 1 Tier 2 benefit, you may invest 3XP to gain each Tier 3 benefit.

- Attunement to Wizardry
 - Intellect substitution for spells Expanded range casting in tier 3 Custom spell?
- Attunement to Martial Arts
 - Spread damage out from an attack action among a number of targets

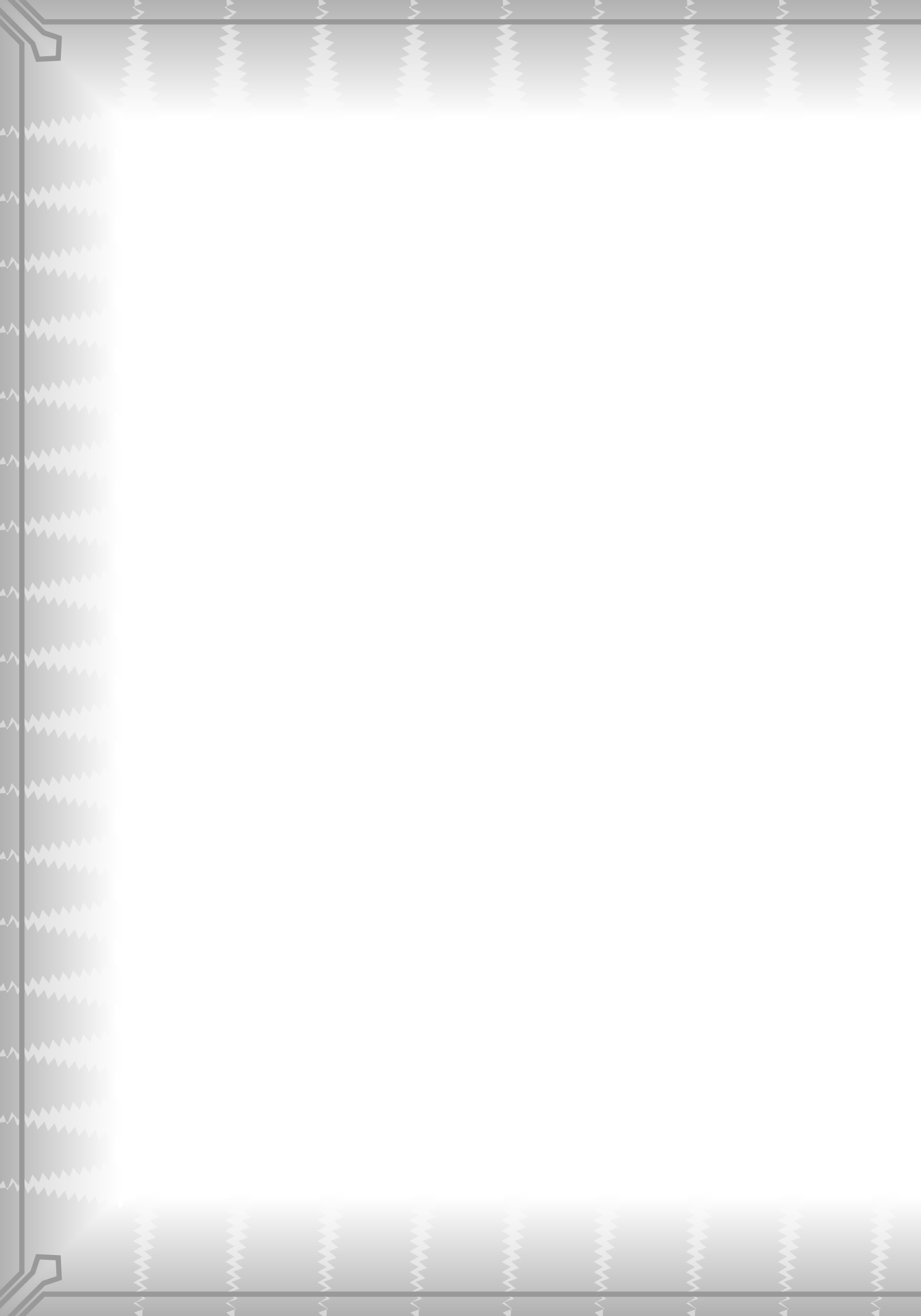
Attunement to A Weapon
Spread damage out from an attack action among a number of targets
Attunement to A Patron Spirit

Will substitution for spells
Attunement to Nature
Attunement to Engineering
Attunement to Subterfuge



Part II

The Setting



Overview of the Gamma Nebula

Gamma Nebula is a futuristic setting in another universe where advanced magic has enabled space exploration. The physics and the rules of the Gamma Nebula universe are very different to our own. Gamma Nebula has its own cosmology, history, and cultures, but a Game Master using the setting is encouraged to invent their own.

This book will lay out a framework of the galaxy and the way it works, but the details are left up to the Game Master and players, who may improvisationally create planets and peoples.

It's a big galaxy out there, with surprises and mysteries both ancient and new.

7.1 A brief history

The Gamma Nebula setting takes place in a galaxy called the Great Spiral. There are currently 20 known inhabited worlds in the great spiral governed by the Galactic Alliance, and linked through Fey Space by Fey Corridors.

More than 20,000 years ago, a flourishing galactic civilization of more than 2000 worlds was formed, led by a technologically advanced species known as the Dragons. The Dragons built the Fey Corridor network. Numerous sentient species lived under the rule of the dragons and used the Fey Corridor network for communication and trade. This period of time is referred to as the "Golden Age" or "Draconic Age."

The majority of details of this civi-

lization were lost during the Spiral War 8,000 years ago. Dragons as a species were driven to extinction during the Spiral War.

All Fey Corridors were unusable for the first 1000 years after the Spiral War, and many Fey Corridor openings were completely destroyed or became permanently inoperable. Vast amounts of knowledge and technology were lost during that time, referred to as the Dark Ages.

Gradually, in the ruins of Draconic civilization, the remaining sentient races rebuilt. The first race to establish interstellar travel after the Spiral War were the Wyrmlin, who had access to the most undamaged Dragon technology.

Over the next 3000 years, other civilizations have risen up and joined galactic civilization at large. After some difficult periods of conflict between various governments, the modern Galactic Alliance was established almost 1000 years ago, and has enjoyed political and economic stability for a millenium. Everything that could be recovered from the Golden Age was thought to already be recovered.

But now, new technology has been discovered that enables the operation of long dead Fey Corridors. Hopeful governments and corporations have sponsored thousands of artifact hunters—hopeful explorers looking to investigate long-lost worlds for technology, information, and power from ages past.

Your players are in this galaxy of new opportunities, and it is up to them to decide what to do.

8 The Physics of Gamma Nebula

While the Gamma Nebula Universe looks and acts much like ours on first glance, the underlying rules of reality are very different.

Everything in the universe consists of either *matter* or *magic*. Matter is all physical objects in the world around the characters. Magic is the energy that these objects use to move and interact with each other.

All Matter and Magic is classified into different *elements*. In general it is easier to convert between matter and magic of the same element than it is to go between elements. There are typically only very few matter forms of an element, and infinitely many magic forms of an element. Matter forms of an element are completely stable and do not change except with external influence. Magic forms of an element may change over time without external influence.

The smallest particle of matter in an object is a molecule of a certain element. All but the simplest elements have multiple types of possible molecules of matter.

For the mathematically minded reader- arcanists in the Gamma Nebula Universe have discovered that the elements of the world correspond to the knots of mathematical knot theory. Each element corresponds to knots with a certain number of crossings. Matter forms of an element are prime knots.

8.1 Elements

8.1.1 Base Element

The simplest element that any element can be degraded to is *Essentia* – Element 0. *Essentia* is both matter and magic in one form- there is no distinguishing between matter and magic for *essentia*.

Essentia suffuses the entire universe, and does not directly interact with other matter. However it can be interacted with by magic. When large amounts of *essentia* flow in an appropriate pattern- it can create other magic and matter. This is the basis of casting and enchanting.

The connection between mind and soul appears to be due to a microscopic ordering of *essentia*- and the amount of magical power available to a sentient creature depends on how much *essentia* they can move with their mind and soul.

8.1.2 The Motive Elements

Gravity and Levity are the motive elements. They are both unique in that there are no matter forms of this element, only a single magic form for Gravity and a single magic form for Levity.

All matter and magic higher than *essentia* radiate gravity and levity, and gravity and levity interact with all matter and all magic.

Element 1 and 2

8.1.3 Transformative Elements

The transformative elements both only have one matter form and a handful of magical forms.

- Fire - 3
- Lightning -4

Fire magic and lightning magic is commonly present in some respect in any setting, and most of the elements higher than these two radiate magical forms of these elements in appropriate settings.

Because there is only one matter form of each of these elements, stable fire and lightning are actually fairly uncommon except in *stars*.

8.1.4 Primary Elements

- Air -5
- Water -6
- Metal -7 - gold isoform 1 of metal, is a very unique form of metal which is hard to produce, and very easy to detect if it is pure.
- Earth -8

8.1.5 Noble Elements

The noble elements are essential for life as we know it, and some form of these elements is present at least in small quantities in all living organisms. There are many stable forms of these elements which account for much of the complexity of living organisms.

- Anima -9
- Bone -10

- Acid -11
- Plasm -12
- Blood -13

8.1.6 Higher Elements

Higher elements than element 13 exist but in numerous and multiple forms which are still being studied. Many of the rarer substances in the universe are forms of higher elements.

Higher elements are left more flexible so that the GM and players may improvise what they may be.

8.1.7 Superelements and Void

For elements higher than 42, known as superelements, it is very difficult to find stable forms. Any macroscopic amount of superelements tend to either collapse to true void or become an unstable void-like state that can collapse. True Void is element ∞ .

True void converts matter and magic fed to it into more void. However, if not fed external magic and matter, void consumes *itself* over time, radiating all elements of matter and magic. The smaller the amount of void present, the faster it consumes itself.

Any mass of void smaller than a moon or large asteroid consumes itself in the blink of an eye, releasing a large amount of matter and magic in a powerful explosion.

For this reason, many spells that produce explosive effects actually work by generating a microscopic mass of void which then self-consumes to produce a blast of matter and magic, and this is why these spells leave higher element residue.

9 Species

Hi hi hiiiiiii

Here is the list of RAAACES. they aren't RACIST they are just RACES. YEEEEEEAH.

Species provide either of

- $\{+2\}$ to two different talents
- $\{+2\}$ to one talent and $\{+1\}$ to two different talents.
- $\{+3\}$ to one talent

9.1 Wyrmlinkin

The wyrmlinkin are the most populous race in the galaxy (though by themselves they do not comprise a majority of sentients). They have many dragon-like qualities, including their scales, their elemental breath, and their hatching from warm incubated eggs. It is a common belief among the wyrmlinkin that they carry the blood of the ancient dragons within them because of these similarities.

The wyrmlinkin have many names for themselves, the most common being “shell-born” – referring to their hatching from eggs which is uncommon among sentient races. Other common aliases include “of the holy breath” and “chosen of the dragons,” but these days these phrases are typically only heard among groups entrenched in an attitude of wyrmlinkin superiority over other races.

Appearance

Prehensile Limbs

Wyrmlinkin are of humanoid form with a non-prehensile tail.

[**GRAB LIMBS**] is 2.

Languages

- Standard

Species Bonuses

- {+2}  **INTELLECT**
- {+2}  **CHARISMA**

Species Abilities

- **Wyrm Breath**– Choose one of the *transformative elements* (Fire or lightning). As an action you may produce this element from your mouth in a controlled fashion. If using this to craft or create something, relevant talent checks must still be made. During *phased* mode, you may use this to fill a room temporarily with the element of your choice as a Room Range attack, using Fortitude for your attack roll.
- **Draconic Upbringing**– Start with 1 rank in the skill **FAMILIAR WITH DRAGON CULTURE** at the creation of your character before investing any experience. If this does not apply to the setting you are using this character in, then you may replace this with a different **FAMILIAR** skill at the discretion of the GM.

9.2 Kobolds

Kobolds look superficially similar to the wyrmkin, but have much smaller proportions and have a more raptor-like stature. Unlike the wyrmkin, kobolds have live births rather than hatching from incubated eggs. More insular wyrmkin tend to look down on kobolds as a parody of their race. Historically, kobold communities have faced considerable prejudice from wyrmkin society.

Appearance

Kobolds are covered with scales like many of the reptilian races, but may also have small amounts of featherlike softer scales in some areas of their bodies. Kobold scale colors tend to be either shades of orange, brown, blue, or green, and may have spotted and striped patterns.

Prehensile Limbs

Kobolds are bipedal with two prehensile arms and a prehensile tail.

[**GRAB LIMBS**] is 3.

Languages

- Standard
- Slewback

Species Bonuses

- {+1}  **MEMORY**
- {+2}  **INSIGHT**
- {+1}  **DEXTERITY**

Species Abilities

- **Pack Instinct**– During offensive phased mode, making any sort of helping roll does not consume an action. If helping make a cast or any other consumable ability, a kobold still consumes a cast use or the consumable resource.

9.3 Snakefolk

Appearance

Prehensile Limbs

[GRAB LIMBS] is 2

Languages

- Standard
- Slewback

Species Bonuses

- {+2}  **ATHLETICS**
- {+1}  **WILL**
- {+1}  **CHARISMA**

Species Abilities

- **Serpentine Flexibility**– Receive {+1} on any roll involving this character navigating cramped or narrow space.

Additionally- you may roll  **DEXTERITY** to try to traverse an obstructed connector for one extra movement, contested by  **FORTITUDE** of the character doing the obstructing.

- **Venomous Bite**– Choose between Precision poison, Strength poison, or Grace poison at character creation.

When making a barehanded attack, you can choose to additionally bite the target. If the attack deals any damage, the target is inflicted by the poison you chose at character creation, depleting the relevant characteristic by 1.

9.4 Carcinids

Carcinids are crab-like sentient beings that live in all corners of the galaxy. Many independent communities of carcinids survived the Spiral War in many different.

Most carcinids do not have anything that could be denoted a biological sex. Most carcinids may reproduce by laying eggs which may contain just their own genetic material, or include that of a co-parent.

Appearance

Carcinids have a hard outer carapace around a scaffolding they use as an exoskeleton. They are of smaller stature than most sentients. There are many possible colorations and patterns for a carcinid's carapace.

Prehensile Limbs

Carcinids have 10 limbs they can walk on, 5 of which are free for manipulation

of objects at any given time.

[**GRAB LIMBS**] is 4

Languages

Carcinids are unable to learn to speak any language besides chitter without the use of assistive devices or spells due to the shape of their mouthparts.

- Standard (limited)
- Chitter

Species Bonuses

- {+2}  **DEXTERITY**
- {+2}  **INSIGHT**

Species Abilities

- **Carapace Defense**– You may substitute your Parry with  **FORTITUDE**, even if you currently do not have equipment that grants a parry.

9.5 Humans

An upright, featherless, ape-like bipedal humanoid species nearly identical to the humans in our world.

Appearance

Prehensile Limbs

[GRAB LIMBS] is 2

Languages

- Standard
- Prineu

Species Bonuses

- {+2}  **FORTITUDE**
- {+2}  **WILL**

Species Abilities

9.6 Felinids

Felinids are upright, cat-like humanoids covered in fur.

Appearance

Prehensile Limbs

Languages

- Standard
- Prineu

Species Bonuses

- {+2}  **DEXTERITY**
- {+2}  **CHARISMA**

Species Abilities

- **Feline Agility**– Before taking any non-movement actions during offensive phase, you may make one movement action for free without using an offensive actions.

9.7 Automa

Automa are living machines from the Golden Age. All of them were shutdown by the same weapon that destroyed the fey corridor network. Disabled automa are often found in Golden Age ruins, and occasionally may be in a state where they may be restored to operation by a skilled engineer. Once restored to operation, they are able to heal from injuries, think, and feel like other sentient species.

Automa tend to have very degraded and vague memories of their time before the Spiral War, but this is still considered valuable information by many artifact hunters.

Automa do not have anything comparable to a biological sex, but many of them still identify with the various genders of the other sentient species.

Appearance

Prehensile Limbs

Automa come in various shapes and have a minimum of 2 prehensile limbs. They may have up to 2 additional prehensile limbs determined by the **CONFIGURABLE BODY** species ability.

Languages

- Standard

Species Bonuses

- {+2}  **INTELLECT** - during the **RECUPERATE** action, you can forego this species bonus to have one additional prehensile limb
- {+2}  **FORTITUDE** - during the **RECUPERATE** action, you can forego this species bonus to have one additional prehensile limb

Species Abilities

- **Essentia Essentials**– Automa do not need to eat or breathe. They appear to draw on the same power that Fey Corridors draw on. When taking the **RECUPERATE** downtime action, Automa do not consume rations. Additionally they are unaffected by hostile atmospheres or a lack of atmosphere.
- **Configurable Body**– Whenever you take the **RECUPERATE** downtime action, you may add up to 2 additional [**GRAB LIMBS**] by forgoing your Species bonuses.

Each Species bonus you forgo gives you 1 additional Grab Limb.

9.8 Species template

Appearance

Prehensile Limbs

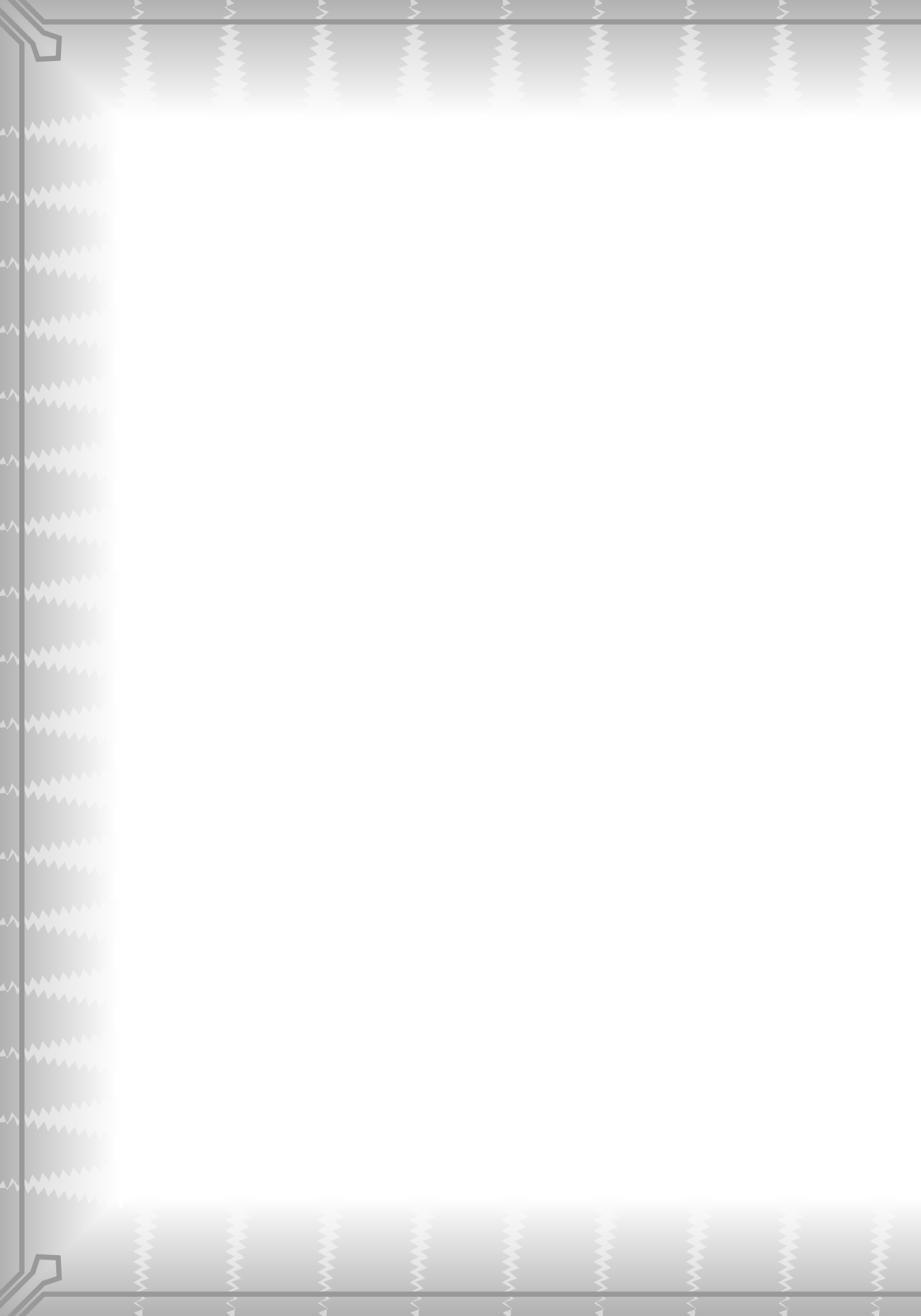
Languages

Species Bonuses

Species Abilities

Part III

Appendices



Appendix: Mathematical Formulas

For the probability of success for a roll $RXaY$:

$$[\text{PROBABILITY}] = \begin{cases} \text{if } Y \geq 12, & 100\% \\ \text{if } 12 > Y > 0, & 1 - \left(\frac{12 - Y}{12}\right)^X \\ \text{if } Y = 0, & 1 - \left(\frac{11}{12}\right)^X \\ \text{if } 0 > Y \geq -X, & \left(\frac{11}{12}\right)^{(-Y-1)} - \left(\frac{11}{12}\right)^X \times \left(\frac{10}{11}\right)^{(-Y-1)} \\ \text{if } -X > Y, & 0\% \end{cases} \quad (\text{Appendix:.1})$$

Appendix: Gamma Runes

Gamma runes are the most common runic system in the Gamma Nebula Universe. Casts are performed by channeling essentia along the shapes of gamma runes- which directly creates magical effects in the world. More runes and more complex effects need a larger amount of channeled essentia to actually create the desired effect.

Other runic systems exist, but the gamma rune system has been refined by arcanists over several millenia to account for almost all possible magical effects.

It is optional to learn Gamma Runes for gameplay. A GM who has learned Gamma Runes should not force any player to learn Gamma Runes.

Most situations can just be narrated vaguely during gameplay by saying the player found a loophole in a spell, or realized they could modify the runes to produce a certain effect. However, a GM and a player who have both learned Gamma Runes can include segments of gameplay where the player actually deciphers or debugs underlying runes.

- input runes
- output runes
- selectors
- numbers

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